Ep #10 | WTF is the Next Gen Thinking? Nikhil w/ Navya, Tara, Aadit & Kaivalya

[Speaker 1] (0:00 - 0:38)

We started today trying to establish what people in your generation are thinking. So we're going to spend the first five minutes today talking about how kids of today, the 20-year-old Zepto guys can't figure...

[Speaker 4] (0:38 - 0:41)

I literally think they've just reached. I think they've just reached. I heard some noise.

[Speaker 1] (0:41 - 0:53)

It's not them, right? Then it makes sense. Tara and Navya, I want to ask you guys, what is wrong with the youth of today that they can't make it to any place on time?

[Speaker 4] (0:55 - 1:03)

Navya, take it away. I'm a part of the youth, so I don't want to comment because I'm one of these people. I was also late.

[Speaker 1] (1:04 - 1:05)

You were not late, really.

[Speaker 4] (1:05 - 1:18)

I was kind of on time. I mean, I wasn't as late as them, but I was a little late. Were you late?

Because if you were late, then I was definitely late. We were all late, to be honest, but I think they've taken the bar a little too high. I know, being very late.

Why is that? It's unacceptable. We should stand for...

[Speaker 1] (1:18 - 1:31)

Normally, when you guys go out, say, Tara and Navya are going out to dinner with their friends. If that respective friend was to make you wait an hour, what would you do?

[Speaker 4] (1:31 - 1:36)

I would eat and leave. I mean, I would eat. I would definitely eat as well.

[Speaker 1] (1:37 - 1:38)

So what should we do with them?

[Speaker 4] (1:39 - 1:42)

I mean, I would like to eat and then leave.

[Speaker 1] (1:46 - 1:49)

Let's just do it. Maybe we should punish them.

[Speaker 3] (1:50 - 1:52)

How so? Any ideas? Interesting.

[Speaker 1] (1:52 - 1:56)

You guys come up with it. You pick one, she'll pick another. And we'll punish them.

[Speaker 3] (1:57 - 2:04)

I'm not really good at this stuff. Nikhil, you're the Vogue one. Maybe you can help us with this.

[Speaker 4] (2:04 - 2:05)

Well, they hate me.

[Speaker 5] (2:05 - 2:05)

I'm sorry.

[Speaker 4] (2:06 - 2:10)

And we're dressed exactly the same. Nice to meet you. Hi.

Nice to meet you.

[Speaker 5] (2:10 - 2:12)

Hi, Navya. Nice to meet you. Hi, Navya.

[Speaker 4] (2:12 - 2:13)

Nice to meet you.

[Speaker 2] (2:14 - 2:14)

What's up?

[Speaker 4] (2:15 - 2:17)

Everyone's really color coordinated today.

[Speaker 2] (2:17 - 2:27)

I get some... Your background sucks. I get some ass.

Because I want to feel off. But now I'm feeling a bit better. I'm feeling a bit better.

But I... Whole day got ruined as a result of that.

[Speaker 3] (2:28 - 2:29)

Gosh, do you want some medicine or something?

[Speaker 2] (2:29 - 2:33)

Yeah, I popped some paracetamol. Like before this one. Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (2:33 - 2:34)

I can't say anything else now.

[Speaker 2] (2:41 - 2:43)

So you're also planning the right excuse, you know?

[Speaker 1] (2:43 - 2:44)

So someone from your...

[Speaker 2] (2:44 - 2:49)

Oh my god, did you just pull on that act? Wow, I mean, I have the paracetamol to prove it.

[Speaker 4] (2:49 - 2:50)

That's fine.

[Speaker 2] (2:50 - 2:51)

I'm gonna...

[Speaker 4] (2:52 - 2:53)

We believe you.

[Speaker 2] (2:53 - 2:54)

I have the full set. I've planned all of it.

[Speaker 4] (2:55 - 2:57)

What were some of the other excuses that I'm kind of curious to know?

[Speaker 2] (2:58 - 3:00)

Dude, it was just work? Yeah.

[Speaker 4] (3:00 - 3:02)

Not traffic. Because we've all just driven through the traffic.

[Speaker 2] (3:03 - 3:04)

So what did we miss?

[Speaker 1] (3:05 - 3:52)

So much. The whole call. So today's conversation, like every other conversation, is not me asking you questions.

It's all of us talking to each other. And because you guys are today as precociously successful in your own ways, you know, you guys are doing something else. She's doing something else.

She's doing something else. When I thought in my mind, let's bring a bunch of people who are under the age of 28 together, because that seems to be the largest market to build for in India. I thought, let me bring really different people who are completely different from each other and then see, you know, what comes.

Interesting. So it'll be interesting.

[Speaker 2] (3:52 - 3:53)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (3:53 - 3:53)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (3:53 - 3:54)

Fascinating.

[Speaker 1] (3:54 - 3:59)

So maybe we should start with introductions. Tell us a bit about yourself.

[Speaker 2] (3:59 - 4:02)

Oh no. I've seen the podcast. I was expecting this.

[Speaker 1] (4:02 - 4:02)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (4:03 - 4:03)

Big fans, man.

[Speaker 1] (4:04 - 4:04)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (4:06 - 4:10)

But KV, you want to go first? Both of our introductions are going to end up being similar.

[Speaker 1] (4:10 - 4:11)

And how old are you guys now?

[Speaker 2] (4:12 - 4:12)

20.

[Speaker 1] (4:12 - 4:14)

Which school did you guys go to?

[Speaker 2] (4:14 - 4:14)

This was in Dubai.

[Speaker 1] (4:15 - 4:15)

Oh, okay.

[Speaker 2] (4:15 - 4:16)

Where do you want me to start?

[Speaker 1] (4:17 - 4:19)

Start from Dubai, where you went to school.

[Speaker 2] (4:20 - 4:30)

So I was born in Bombay. And then when I was about five, moved to Dubai. And we ended up in the same class in like the third grade.

Dubai was fun. A little bit sheltered, but fun.

[Speaker 1] (4:31 - 4:32)

Why shelter?

[Speaker 2] (4:32 - 4:36)

There's no crime. There's like a bit of a bubble. So...

[Speaker 1] (4:36 - 4:37)

It's changed now, no?

[Speaker 2] (4:38 - 4:47)

Not really. No? Not really.

Now, in fact, like... So growing up, I never thought that I'd be like spending the rest of my life in India. But now when I go back to Dubai...

[Speaker 1] (4:47 - 4:51)

Why did India appear so bad? I'm going to be a little bit harsher to you guys.

[Speaker 2] (4:51 - 8:07)

That's fine. No, that's fine. So it's just that...

I get the pass though. The school that we went to, the typical path, most people ended up going to either the UK, US or Canada for university. And so that was just like the set paths.

And so... So yeah, we went to school together. I started programming when I was like 10 or 11.

And so we'd work on a bunch of projects growing up. Did you live next to each other? No.

For a bit. For a bit. Yeah, by Dubai.

Yeah. So we... So basically, the two of us, we...

I think both of us had a bit of an act for building. Pretty boring to say. But yeah, we used to...

I think as kids, both of us had dads who were engineers. Sort of pushed into that world pretty early on. That's how we bonded as well.

KB is always a lot more technical and smarter than I was. So he built out the actually interesting stuff. I just did the talking.

And yeah, but we used to work on things together. By the time two of us were 17, we said, okay, how do we make a career out of this hobby? How do we build for a living?

And that's when, I guess when you were 14, 15, we started getting exposed to Y Combinator startup school, if you guys have heard of that. It's like a... No, this was like an online course that they had.

Yeah, yeah. So basically, towards the end of school, we said, how do we build a career out of building? And we figured that from the Y Combinator YouTube videos and the sessions that we used to see online, we realized that this is a community of people in Silicon Valley that basically build for a living, right?

And we said, how do we get... What's the best excuse to get there? What's the best excuse for two Indian kids in Dubai to get there?

Probably go to college there. And so two of us applied. We figured Stanford would be a good excuse to go there.

Lucky enough to get in. And so yeah, that was supposed to be the beginning of the journey. You got in together?

Yeah, I mean, he got in early. I didn't get in early. I got into the decision cycle.

So that's still... We were supposed to start in September of 2020. Right.

And did you go to college? No, no, no. In fact, we didn't.

I mean, we... So we were supposed to go. So March 2020, pandemic hits.

Two of us were supposed to go. Couldn't go. And we said, okay, we can start our college education online.

But we had like four precious years in like Silicon Valley. So we said, you know, if we're going to waste a year sitting on our laptops in Dubai or Mumbai, it's not really worth it. And so we decided to take a year off.

And we didn't really have anything planned for that year. A lot of our friends had internships at Goldman or J.P. Morgan. But we were...

We just said, let's take a year off, figure out what we can do. And yeah, that's when we started experimenting. What was the first experiment?

So we came to Bombay, firstly, like when the pandemic hit. Came to Bombay, multiple reasons. My family was here.

It was COVID. So we were staying in KV's house in Andheri East. And so yeah, that's basically where we were.

So we were within reach of our family in Bombay. But we were staying alone. And we took a year off.

March, April 2020, lockdown. Your local mom and pop shop was disrupted. The online guys were taking seven, eight days to deliver.

It was a pain. And most of our neighbors were elderly. And so we were on a WhatsApp group chat.

And we just used to deliver for them because we had nothing else to do.

[Speaker 1] (8:08 - 8:09)

And you would charge a fee for this?

[Speaker 2] (8:10 - 8:19)

Initially, we didn't. That WhatsApp group grew. Eventually, we started hitting that limit.

256. Yeah, 256 KV remembers. But yeah.

[Speaker 1] (8:19 - 8:21)

But each person could see what their neighbor was ordering?

[Speaker 2] (8:22 - 9:48)

Yeah, it was not very, not ideal. This is like, so my place was in this like, it's called Sherry Punjab colony. It was just a bunch of Punjabis in like, I don't know, 50 years ago, 40 years ago or something.

And so it's just, I don't know, maybe a hundred, 200 houses there. So it's just the people within that. And like, we were three stores nearby that we would pick up and stuff off.

And so that was that. And when it got to a certain point, we said, let's build an app out of it. So we can scale this.

And so we built out the first rendition. It was called Kirana Card. And yeah, it was basically a pick up and drop service.

And that's what, that's how we ended up building out and started scaling over the course of like a couple of months. And that's pretty much all we would do. We were like the customer support executives.

We were the delivery partners, the delivery drivers. We were the guys that, you know, packed the orders for the store. And we used to do that for like 60, 70% of the time.

We've got some crazy stories. Save that for the podcast. But that was the journey.

And like, as we were going through that, we interacted with customers so much, it became clear to us that if we really wanted to make something meaningful and scale this, we would have to, I mean, we would have to just control the customer experience end to end. And so that's when we started experimenting with dark stores. What is a dark store?

Yeah, so you can think about, you know, a dark store is like a micro warehouse, or you can think of it like a supermarket, right, in the sense that you've got these aisles. But unlike a supermarket, it's tucked away in a back alley somewhere. So not in a front-facing road.

And instead of having customers moving around those aisles, you've got pickers and packers that are zipping around, you know, packing those.

[Speaker 1] (9:48 - 9:50)

How big is a typical dark store?

[Speaker 2] (9:50 - 10:07)

It's about three and a half thousand square feet. I mean, let's say 3,000 square feet of carpet. So we started experimenting with that, right?

I mean, not only did it help us deliver faster, short term was meaningfully better, quality was meaningfully better, speed was, or at least have like a better handle on pricing than we initially did.

[Speaker 1] (10:07 - 10:10)

So how did you go from delivering groceries on WhatsApp?

[Speaker 2] (10:10 - 10:10)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (10:11 - 10:14)

Did you guys start a company? Where did the money to start a dark store come from?

[Speaker 2] (10:14 - 10:52)

Yeah, I know, sure. So, and when we started getting like very early traction, we applied to this, and we actually met Will, who was the first investor in the company. We applied to this thing called A Country Capital, it was a fellowship.

And it was a crazy idea for two kids sitting in Bombay. They basically said, we'll give you 40 lakhs for free. And like, no questions asked, just take 40 lakhs if you're building something interesting.

It's basically, so in COVID, a whole bunch of people were taking gap years. Start up or whatever. And so these guys said, we'll pick five teams that are working on something.

They're taking time off of school. So at that point, we're like a student focused VC fund. So I said, we'll give $50,000 to five teams that are working on something in a gap year.

[Speaker 1] (10:52 - 10:53)

Is this still open? Can people apply?

[Speaker 2] (10:54 - 10:55)

I don't know if the fellowship is open, but the fund is there.

[Speaker 1] (10:55 - 10:57)

The fund is there. What is it called?

[Speaker 2] (10:57 - 11:07)

Country Capital. Yeah. In fact, well, so the guy that had invested, he was in India last weekend for the first time.

So the first time meeting him in person since he put in that.

[Speaker 1] (11:07 - 11:08)

Does he still have equity?

[Speaker 2] (11:08 - 11:31)

Yeah, he's a meaningful. So he gave us basically 50k USD at a two and a half million valuation.

And we were like, wow, that's amazing.

Like, we were just like, that's crazy. We were like, that's, that's, we thought we were just like putting a fast one of these guys. Yeah, I mean, it was like, we were like two kids sitting in a, in a living room on a WhatsApp group chat.

And someone's like, okay, this is two and a half million dollars. And I was like, okay, great.

[Speaker 1] (11:31 - 11:32)

And what did you do with the 40 lakhs?

[Speaker 2] (11:33 - 11:46)

So we started. And I think like the initially really, we didn't have much of a plan. It was just like, like our day-to-day was basically like 50k.

Like in the early days, when you get like a pre-seed, a cap, and I'm sure you know this, right? Most of it is just to like live. So we barely spent it.

[Speaker 1] (11:46 - 11:50)

How did it start scaling? You had a WhatsApp group? Share a Punjab?

[Speaker 2] (11:53 - 13:05)

It was pretty fun. So I think this investment happened in like August or September 2020. And October, November, December.

So typically with marketplace businesses, you have a chicken and egg problem, right? For example, a food delivery business. Either you have restaurants.

Without restaurants, it's hard to get customers. And without customers, it's hard to get restaurants. It's like a chicken and egg problem.

And so we were like, we had that same thing. And so we were like, okay, fine. Which side do we solve first?

We said, let's solve the supply side. And so every day for those three months, we would just go to a different neighborhood in Bombay. Like one day it'd be Parel or Powai or Borivali or Colaba.

We just walk into as many of these Kirana stores. And try to convince them to join as a seller. Over those three months, we went to every single neighborhood.

We'd walk into stores all day. Like morning to evening. And just do that.

So neither of us had any sort of background in sales. But like trying to sell software to like a Baniya is probably the best crash course in sales that anyone can do. It's unbelievable.

Because out of 10 of them, 8 will tell you to like, I don't know if I... To f**k, basically. And two of them will say, okay, fine, I'll download your app.

And by the time you walk out, one of those two is deleted. And so they would give us feedback though. On like what they need to improve.

[Speaker 1] (13:05 - 13:07)

Would their margins go down versus selling instead?

[Speaker 2] (13:08 - 13:10)

Slightly, like 2-3%.

[Speaker 1] (13:10 - 13:11)

And how much would you charge?

[Speaker 2] (13:11 - 13:43)

I mean, at that point, we were charging 2-3% commission. We were like, we just want to cover the payment gain. We were trying to figure out like the, I mean, different types of product market fit.

Like commerce and retail, right? So when the first core product market fit for any business is customer product market fit. And then you get the economics product market fit.

So we were just solving for number one. In 2020, how much did you sell? We hadn't launched the customer side yet.

Yeah, we launched it in January. Like with the app basically. 2021, how much did you sell?

So within 30 days of launching, 30-40 days, we got to about 300 orders a day. Right? So we were doing...

[Speaker 1] (13:43 - 13:44)

What is the average order?

[Speaker 2] (13:45 - 13:54)

Back then it was like 280-290 rupees payback. We were doing 300 orders a day. Very low AOV.

But it scaled pretty quickly. What is AOV? Average order value.

[Speaker 5] (13:54 - 13:54)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (13:55 - 14:10)

WTF is AOV. But yeah, so very low average order value. But we were seeing product market fit.

And we would talk to customers because we would be the ones doing the deliveries. We had set up like our own mini customer support center in KV's house. And his mom is not very happy about that.

[Speaker 1] (14:10 - 14:12)

And when did the 40 lakhs run out?

[Speaker 2] (14:12 - 14:33)

No, so okay. In this process, we raised 40 lakhs. And then we kept like raising like 20 lakhs follow up from like a couple of other angel investors in Contrary's network.

And then when we got to like a certain scale, we got... Or not when we got to a certain scale. We got to a certain level where it started looking like we were gaining momentum.

We got approached by Y Combinator. So this would have been late 2020.

[Speaker 1] (14:34 - 14:35)

And they would have done half a million or something.

[Speaker 2] (14:36 - 14:38)

125k. It was 125k. It was 125k.

[Speaker 1] (14:39 - 14:40)

How does one apply to Y Combinator?

[Speaker 2] (14:41 - 14:52)

They have a form. So they run two batches every year. January to March.

And then July to September. They have a bunch of questions. You fill them in and apply.

And you meet them in person? No, no.

[Speaker 1] (14:52 - 14:53)

In a non-COVID world?

[Speaker 2] (14:54 - 15:49)

Sometimes. Yeah. So I think the interviews are virtual now.

So they have like a 10-minute interview. I've heard of this. It's just like a coffee shop.

Before COVID, they used to come down to Bangalore and do it. But they also do it virtually. Okay, so 125k then.

So we launched zero orders per day. Mid-Feb is when we launched. Okay, sorry.

Mid-Feb, yeah. Around that time. Jan-Feb.

So we launched within 45 days. We got like about 300 orders per day. But when we were doing it, we realized we would speak to customers.

And they would tell us upfront, hey, we're using the app. There's a lockdown. We don't really want to go out.

But we don't really like the app. It's not that good, right? Once this lockdown is over, we're just going to go back to buying offline.

And we said, shit. So we don't really have product-market fit. Like we had induced product-market fit because of the weird circumstances.

And so that's when we started talking to them. And that's pretty much what we spent a good week on, just talking to people. And we realized that, okay, our speed sucked.

So that was one. And you have...

[Speaker 1] (15:49 - 15:51)

How long did it take back then? 60 minutes.

[Speaker 2] (15:51 - 15:58)

60 minutes. 45 to 60 minutes. That sucked?

It sucked because, you know, you've got the local... I mean, you can just go downstairs and pick it up in 5-10 minutes otherwise.

[Speaker 1] (15:58 - 16:02)

What is the difference in cost between delivering in 2 hours and 20 minutes?

[Speaker 2] (16:03 - 16:56)

We're giving all the trade secrets in this podcast. But we've got the lower your distance per delivery, you actually get into this positive flywheel where you're delivering faster. And the lower your distance per delivery, you actually do more throughput per delivery partner.

Like what KB said. So with the same... Like if I'm paying somebody, to give you a sense, right?

What is your last mile cost per order? It's how much you're paying a delivery driver per hour divided by how many orders is he doing per hour. What is that typically?

Like it varies by city, but let's say 75 rupees per hour. Varies by city, varies by vehicle type. Petroleum bike could be 75.

Other formats would be different. But yeah, so 75 rupees per hour. And if he does one order per hour, your cost for every delivery is 75.

But if he's doing two orders per hour, your cost for every delivery is 35. Why doesn't everybody else do this? Deliver faster.

I mean, people are delivering faster. I mean, you saw the Amazon memo globally, right? They're all pushing for fast delivery.

People really care about it. I mean, we see this meaningfully in the retention difference.

[Speaker 1] (16:56 - 17:01)

Okay, so 2021 end. 2022 financial year. How much did...

[Speaker 2] (17:04 - 18:42)

FY21, nothing. Like probably a couple lakhs. 22?

July 21, we actually started like the first dark store and started running the business. Just to give some context. End of March, 45 days into mid-Feb to end of March.

Basically, we decided that, okay, this marketplace model not working. And we said, we'll pivot to the dark store model. Spend a couple of months, then hiring a bit of a team, figuring it out.

And then July 21 is when we launched the first dark store. And yeah, from July 21 to today, like about 24 months, went from about zero to two. Like today, north of 5,000 crores in sales.

So crazy. That was crazy. That's like...

When did money come in for the first time? Like serious fundraisers? Yeah, so Nexus.

They essentially did our series A. And they were... So this was actually like...

So they approached us. And we told them, hey, they said, okay, this business is interesting. What are you doing?

Get on our card. 300 orders per day pretty quickly. Maybe you can scale.

We actually, the first meeting we told them, we're going to shut this down. This doesn't work. Like we're talking to customers and they're just telling us this doesn't work.

Right. So we're shutting it down. And that was the first meeting.

Like they said, we're interested in funding you. And we said, we're shutting this business down. So like don't fund us.

And then we started and then said, okay, we're shutting it down. What are you going to do? And we told them that we think this model has got better product market fit.

And so when we walked them through the thesis, we actually showed them the customer data. They were like, okay, this is exciting. And that's when they funded us.

So they put in, that was a $10 million series A that they did. When was that? This was right before July 2021.

From then it went pretty crazy. So July 21, the first stocks that we launched in Bandra went crazy. And we started growing.

And these are good times. We started growing 100% a week. It was like crazy.

[Speaker 1] (18:43 - 18:46)

How do you match for that scale? You need physical people to deliver, right?

[Speaker 2] (18:46 - 18:47)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (18:47 - 18:52)

Or did you have idle drivers who were delivering one order an hour? And they just became what they should.

[Speaker 2] (18:53 - 19:35)

Yeah, that's how we did. Initially when we launched at ArcStore. But yeah, so we're going 100, 150% a week.

We raised like this $10 million series A within 45 days of that. Again, without exact, like it was crazy. But within 45 days of that, we closed a $50 million series B.

And then the business started really going crazy. This is post COVID craziness. Post COVID craziness, right?

Like 150% a week, 200% a week. We were like multiplying the business every week. It was like, it was on like, we were barely sleeping.

Like we were sleeping like three, four hours a day without exaggeration. And then yeah, like 70 days into that, we raised like the $100 million series C. And then yeah, that's when we started getting.

Series C was December 21. And it was led by Y Combinator's growth fund.

[Speaker 1] (19:35 - 19:36)

And how many have you done now?

[Speaker 2] (19:37 - 19:41)

We just did our fifth round. And also series E, Friday.

[Speaker 1] (19:41 - 19:42)

How much have you raised totally?

[Speaker 2] (19:43 - 19:43)

530.

[Speaker 1] (19:45 - 19:48)

How does it feel to be 20 years old and get $500 million?

[Speaker 2] (19:49 - 19:54)

21 in eight days. So I'll put that. Obvious question, right?

[Speaker 1] (19:54 - 19:56)

People must ask you this a lot.

[Speaker 2] (19:57 - 20:02)

I mean, it's like, it doesn't feel like much. You've got a lot more to do. Long way to go.

[Speaker 1] (20:02 - 20:04)

I know you have a lot to do, but how does $500 million feel?

[Speaker 2] (20:04 - 20:05)

No, I mean, really.

[Speaker 1] (20:06 - 20:15)

How much is left? The last round I'm sure is left. Do you guys still have relevant, significant enough equity on the cap table?

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (20:16 - 20:18)

I mean, so the two of us own about 25%.

[Speaker 1] (20:18 - 20:28)

And on your, say, unit economics, say 75 rupees per hour, driving cost at some point of time. How much are you passing on to your client today? And how much are you charging?

[Speaker 2] (20:29 - 21:12)

The dark souls that we work with, they do multiple times more throughput per square foot than any other format of commerce in the country, offline and online. So rent as a percentage of sales for us is nothing. It's one, one and a half percent.

So the fixed cost base is so low because of how much throughput that we've been able to do within the same store. Because of how much customer demand we see and the way that we've designed the stores. So throughput is crazy.

Fixed cost is very low. And then on the variable cost side, which is the last mile cost, all your per order costs, that's something that we optimize. But we basically, like we've gotten it to a pretty good level right now.

We basically make margins from the sale and we make advertising income. So like a Unilever, Procter & Gamble will advertise on the platform. We make a meaningful amount of advertising income.

Because this is a 100% margin business.

[Speaker 1] (21:12 - 21:16)

Because I was talking to Meesho and they said delivery income is a big portion of the revenue.

[Speaker 2] (21:17 - 21:17)

Yeah, yeah, yeah.

[Speaker 1] (21:17 - 21:22)

So if you had to break up your revenue into four quadrants, can you break that up?

[Speaker 2] (21:22 - 22:05)

It's three. I mean, it's like sales, advertising income and delivery fees. Percentage?

Yeah, so we're going into the trade secrets again. But yeah, so like sales is like the core, right? Like inventory sales is like what most of it is.

And then ad income and delivery fees is like between 1% and 3% of sales. Yeah, delivery fee is very small. So we do free delivery above Rs.

199. We don't really rely too much on delivery fees. That's also because like a marketplace business, Meesho is like a zero commission business.

And so they have to charge delivery fee. So compared to most other formats of grocery, we actually have a meaningfully higher margin structure. And we are also cheaper.

We're not as cheap as, let's say, the DMarts of the world. That's very deep. But we're like meaningfully cheaper than most formats of grocery.

[Speaker 1] (22:06 - 22:14)

I was talking to someone about Zepto and they compared you with DMart. Are you guys trying to compete with DMart? Or are you trying to compete with QuickCommerce?

[Speaker 2] (22:15 - 22:30)

I mean, the way that we look at it, it's like, you know, this business is so tough. It's like one of those businesses where you need to have this like insane obsession with operating excellence and discipline. If you crack it somehow, then you can build a massive business.

If you look at...

[Speaker 1] (22:30 - 22:33)

What percentage is grocery of consumption? Because I was trying to work out this number.

[Speaker 2] (22:33 - 22:35)

70% of retail is what I...

[Speaker 1] (22:35 - 22:45)

But if you were to say broadly consumption, let's say Indian GDP, 65% is consumption. We leave exports and all of that out. 70% of...

[Speaker 2] (22:45 - 22:46)

70% of that.

[Speaker 1] (22:46 - 23:05)

Let's say in America, for example, 70% of consumption or 60% is QSR. If I were to break... Apparently that... Yeah.

Food is such a big component in the US. Yeah. If I were to break that down for India and put a tag against groceries, what percentage would it be?

[Speaker 2] (23:05 - 23:23)

70. Like it's like the... It's the majority of consumption.

Like, so if you... X is GDP. 70% of it is...

65% of it is consumption. 70% of 65% is grocery. So you're like...

Your definition of grocery is like wide ranging, right? Perishables, milk, you know, in some cases meat.

[Speaker 1] (23:23 - 23:25)

And I'm guessing organized is not more than 10-20%.

[Speaker 2] (23:25 - 23:27)

Organized is like 5. It's... Yeah, something like that.

[Speaker 1] (23:28 - 23:30)

It's 8%. Right. Okay, who's going next?

[Speaker 4] (23:30 - 23:32)

Why is everyone looking at me? I'm gonna look here.

[Speaker 1] (23:32 - 23:36)

Okay, Navya, tell us something about you. I know you.

[Speaker 4] (23:36 - 23:39)

Yeah, so I don't know. You're gonna have to hear this again. Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (23:39 - 23:45)

It's interesting how people think of themselves because it's very often not how other people think of them. Really?

[Speaker 4] (23:45 - 23:49)

What do you think of me, Nikhil? I'll take it from there. I'll take it from there.

[Speaker 1] (23:49 - 23:51)

I think we should all talk about what we think of each other.

[Speaker 4] (23:51 - 23:52)

I'll take it from there.

[Speaker 1] (23:52 - 24:21)

I think Navya is this very intelligent, very good looking girl born in a situation where life would have ideally taken her in another direction. But the fact that she's choosing not to do so leaves a lot of people intrigued. Because to a layman, to people like us who have no exposure to fame and popularity like Bollywood affords somebody.

[Speaker 4] (24:21 - 24:38)

Have you met the two of them recently? I think everyone knows who they are. Actually, I mean, when you say that, I actually, I don't know, a lot of people know this.

I grew up in Delhi. I'm from Delhi. Okay.

So I'm not from Bombay. I didn't grow up in this whole environment that I think most people assume that I grew up in.

[Speaker 1] (24:38 - 24:52)

I'll add a bit of context. Your grandfather is Amitabh Bachchan. Grandmother is a MP.

The other side grandmother is someone who has a Guinness Book of World Record for selling 17,000 insurance policies in a day.

[Speaker 4] (24:52 - 24:53)

Yes, she worked in insurance.

[Speaker 1] (24:53 - 25:04)

Wow. In a day? In a day.

What? And her father runs a really large listed company called Escorts. Kubota now.

Escorts Kubota. Which does, should I say, agri-machinery?

[Speaker 4] (25:05 - 25:07)

Yeah, agri-machinery, tractors, construction equipment.

[Speaker 1] (25:07 - 25:10)

And you spend time on that too, right? Yeah. Most of your time?

[Speaker 4] (25:11 - 25:13)

Around 60% of my time.

[Speaker 1] (25:13 - 25:22)

Because when I meet Navya, we generally, you know, the questions I ask her is, you know, how is manufacturing? What's happening with tractor business? Interesting.

It's slightly different.

[Speaker 4] (25:22 - 26:13)

Yeah. So yeah, I think a lot of people assume I grew up in Bombay. That's not true.

I grew up in Delhi. I studied there till I was 12. I went to boarding school at 12 in the UK.

I studied there for five years. Then I went to college in the US for five years. And I graduated, I mean, I came back during the lockdown.

I finished my senior year online. So good call not doing that. It was not fun.

I graduated during COVID 2020, May 2020. I actually started, I run a non-profit. So I started my non-profit in May 2020 as well.

So during COVID. And we started, so some context. My non-profit works mainly in areas of education, healthcare, legal awareness and entrepreneurship for women.

[Speaker 1] (26:13 - 26:14)

Project Naveli.

[Speaker 4] (26:14 - 26:53)

Yeah, Project Naveli. And we started with healthcare, actually. And it started during lockdown, where we actually were running sanitary pad drives for women who didn't have access to menstrual hygiene products during lockdown because they were not able to leave their homes.

This was more in Chawls in Mumbai. From there, we went into entrepreneurship, legal awareness and education. So we have, our entrepreneurship community is about 25,000 women.

So these are very small scale entrepreneurs, mostly housewives, mothers who decided to start like different services during lockdown.

[Speaker 1] (26:53 - 27:06)

I have to say this about Navya. She's very low key. Like when she comes to Bangalore, she doesn't pretend to be, or she doesn't behave like that person.

And there's no starry behavior.

[Speaker 4] (27:06 - 27:34)

I mean, because I feel like I'm not the one who's the star. Like I haven't done that work. I haven't gained that respect.

So I have no right projecting that just because I come from somewhere. And I think that like every time people ask me that, oh, you run a nonprofit and most privileged people or people from privilege run a nonprofit. I'm like, you know, if you exclude whether I'm privileged or not and focus on what I do, then that's a completely different conversation altogether.

[Speaker 1] (27:35 - 27:36)

What is the trigger? Why nonprofit?

[Speaker 4] (27:37 - 28:03)

The first answer to that is that whether I come from the family I come from or not, whether I came from privilege or not, I think I'd still be doing what I'm doing. So for me, if I had to define myself, I would not say I'm a philanthropist. I'd say I'm a social entrepreneur because I'm essentially

building businesses, but I'm not chasing profit.

I'm chasing purpose. So I'm kind of like the middleman between being completely purpose-centric and profit-centric. I'm kind of in the middle.

[Speaker 1] (28:03 - 28:06)

Are you capitalistic or socialist at heart?

[Speaker 4] (28:06 - 28:20)

I'm kind of in the middle somewhere. Because see, essentially what I do on a day-to-day basis and everything I run, these are businesses, but we're not making profits, right? So it's somewhere in the middle.

And I mean, that's a conversation for later.

[Speaker 2] (28:20 - 28:24)

Only Nikhil makes profit. Nobody else does. Yeah, so everybody else is just trying their best.

[Speaker 4] (28:24 - 28:25)

So but somehow I feel that that's kind of...

[Speaker 1] (28:25 - 28:41)

Can I tell you something? Yeah. You guys are 20 years old.

I've been doing the same job I do today. I'm 36 as a trader for 19 years. I was just thinking about it when you were introducing yourself.

I've had the same job for how old you guys are. So it's okay if I make a little bit of money?

[Speaker 4] (28:43 - 29:37)

I mean, everyone has to make money. That's the basics of it. So yeah, that's what my non-profit does.

So I was saying we have an entrepreneurship pillar where we have 25,000 women as of last month. And essentially what we do there is encourage entrepreneurship amongst women. So for me, I also fundamentally believe that to encourage people to start businesses, it's more than just capital.

It's more than just investment and finance. It has to be creating an ecosystem. So that's what we do.

So the community is more about resources. We partner with like ad agencies, legal firms to give them access to resources that every founder, as you guys know, would probably need. Which is a very difficult thing for small-scale entrepreneurs to find access to those things.

What happens next?

[Speaker 1] (29:38 - 29:40)

Where is Navya five years from now?

[Speaker 4] (29:40 - 30:23)

I don't know. I don't think she knows either. But I think for me, like, you know, we keep hearing about non-profits and organizations in the US and internationally.

We don't really have one in India that's kind of used as, at least at an international level, as a definition of what social entrepreneurship is. And I think that that's something I'm trying to create is that I think India is a great place for that. We have a lot of people who believe in profit.

We have a lot of people who believe in purpose. How can we bring them together and take that to the world and be an example of that? So I think for me, that's what I'm trying to build with Project Naveli.

I don't know, five years is a little short span of time, but eventually the goal is to kind of get there.

[Speaker 1] (30:24 - 30:25)

And personally?

[Speaker 4] (30:27 - 30:31)

That's a whole other podcast, Nikhil. I don't know if I want to get into that.

[Speaker 2] (30:31 - 30:32)

That's what he wants to get into.

[Speaker 4] (30:32 - 30:40)

Yeah, that's what he's here for. Personally, I would want to kind of build something of my own. I think I've always wanted to do that.

[Speaker 1] (30:40 - 30:41)

For profit, not for profit?

[Speaker 4] (30:41 - 31:07)

No, just I think as my own identity in terms of, you know, I come from a lot and I'm very proud of that. And I also take part in that. I work with my father, like you said.

But at the same time, I think for me, it's always been important to have something that belongs to me. So whether that's the respect that comes from that, whether that's profit, whether that's purpose, whatever that is, I would want that to be something I built by myself. So that's important for me personally.

[Speaker 1] (31:08 - 31:17)

If one were to think all success is relative, starting on step 10 makes it significantly harder?

[Speaker 4] (31:18 - 31:48)

I mean, I don't think I could say that I've had a hard time. I think that for me to wake up at like 21 when I graduated and say that I want to do this and be able to do that is not a reality for a lot of young girls in India. So I think that I definitely had a big advantage.

I think I had it very, very easy comparatively. So I don't know if I'd say it was harder. I'd say that there are other pressures that come with it.

But I think I don't think I'm in a position to complain at all about any of that.

[Speaker 1] (31:49 - 32:00)

Yeah. As a bystander, if you had to describe yourself in one line, personality wise, not like, you know, personality wise. Who is Navya?

[Speaker 4] (32:01 - 32:02)

I'm quite an awkward person.

[Speaker 1] (32:03 - 32:04)

You're not.

[Speaker 4] (32:04 - 32:29)

I am. I'm quite, I do a good job of covering it up, but I'm quite an awkward person. I think it takes me time to get comfortable around people.

And I think that comes from a lot of, because I almost have this like, I know what people think when I walk into a room or I know what they expect me to be like, and I know what kind of perception they would have of me. So immediately there's like...

[Speaker 5] (32:30 - 32:30)

Pressure.

[Speaker 4] (32:30 - 32:51)

Yeah. So I think for me, it takes time to kind of get there. And I think even for people that I've become friends with or work with, it's taken them a while to kind of really get to know who I am.

Because I think there are a lot of preconceived notions, right? And I don't blame people for having those. I would have them if I met, you know, somebody else.

And, you know, before meeting these guys, I thought they were fast and on time.

[Speaker 5] (32:51 - 32:55)

But... Yeah. So here you have, you do have a lot of...

[Speaker 2] (32:55 - 32:56)

How did we segregate that?

[Speaker 5] (32:57 - 32:57)

Wow.

[Speaker 4] (32:58 - 33:20)

I said the two things that you need to sell, which is fast and on time. So I should get a coupon. You can't blame people for having, you know, preconceptions about you.

So I think for me, that's always, I think what creates the awkwardness is that I walk into a room knowing what people are thinking already. And that's a very daunting feeling sometimes.

[Speaker 2] (33:21 - 33:22)

Wow. Interesting.

[Speaker 4] (33:22 - 33:23)

Awkward.

[Speaker 1] (33:23 - 33:24)

Then?

[Speaker 2] (33:24 - 33:25)

Not creative.

[Speaker 4] (33:26 - 33:31)

Like I said, I'm not creative. I know they were having a conversation about how creative they are. And I was like...

[Speaker 1] (33:31 - 33:34)

No, no. I'm not creative. I like looking and admiring at creative people.

[Speaker 4] (33:34 - 33:35)

I don't know. Creative is...

[Speaker 1] (33:35 - 33:36)

You're on numbers, guys.

[Speaker 4] (33:36 - 34:22)

Not creative. I don't know. Why am I answering this kind of question?

Yeah. I think I'm very proud of... I think I grew up in a very traditional setting.

I think my family has always been very, you know, proud about where we come from, our culture, our values. So I think that's kind of what I've grown up in. And I am proud of that too.

I think I've got a good sense of being cultural and traditional. And I think that's a very large reason as to why I moved back. I spent 10 years of my life abroad and still wanted to come back and work here.

I don't think there was ever a point in my life where I felt like I wanted to work in the US or in the UK or anywhere else, but come back and work here. Come back and work in India.

[Speaker 1] (34:23 - 34:24)

Who's going next?

[Speaker 4] (34:25 - 34:27)

Tara's going next.

[Speaker 3] (34:27 - 34:32)

It's decided. Where were you born? I was born in Bombay.

I have a twin sister.

[Speaker 1] (34:33 - 34:33)

Identical?

[Speaker 3] (34:34 - 34:34)

Fraternal twins.

[Speaker 1] (34:35 - 34:36)

What is a fraternal twin?

[Speaker 3] (34:36 - 34:42)

Fraternal twins are basically twins that don't look alike, don't have features that are alike. Essentially, just don't look alike.

[Speaker 1] (34:42 - 34:43)

You were born like 10 minutes apart.

[Speaker 3] (34:43 - 34:47)

We were born... Well, there's an argument. One minute, two minutes.

Who knows?

[Speaker 1] (34:48 - 34:49)

But they're sure you're older.

[Speaker 3] (34:49 - 34:53)

I'm not older. I'm taller, but I'm not older.

[Speaker 1] (34:53 - 34:57)

Are they sure who's younger and who's older?

[Speaker 3] (34:57 - 37:50)

Well, my twin sister says that she's older, so we'll just go with that. So I grew up in Bombay and from... Well, yeah, ever since I can remember, both Pia, my twin sister and I, have been really drawn to the arts.

Like for us, even with our parents, they steered us towards the arts rather than academia, which is something that was relatively rare and I think is still actually quite rare, which is why both of us are such advocates of the arts. Because I feel like it's a conversation that very few people actually talk about when they have children that are growing up. Because obviously, we want kids to do really well in school and college and that's so important.

But I also feel like to just be wholesome and to have a bunch of facets to you that you won't even discover about yourself. Otherwise, it's so important to just have something about you that you can explore in the arts. For me personally, I grew up being, and I still am actually relatively introverted.

I almost always feel like I don't fit in. And I think that that stems from... Actually, I was thinking about it when you asked this question, right?

About childhoods and impacting the future. It definitely does. I grew up very...

I chose to sort of be in my sister's shadow because I was so uncomfortable with being me. I was so introverted and so scared. Actually, the right word to actually use would be scared of everything.

Like I would go to a birthday party with Spia and I remember always telling our chauffeur or our driver or mom or dad to pick me up in five minutes. So take a round and then just pick me up because I can't be at a party and stuff like that. So I was just very afraid.

And I grew up like that. And unfortunately, my school experience and a majority of my college experience was involved a lot of ragging and a lot of bullying. So when I was growing up, I chose to be in the theater a lot.

I chose not to attend college because of the persistent bullying for whatever reason. Because I think I was just different. People didn't know how to accept that because like I said, the conversation about involving the arts with the youth, it just wasn't enough.

And so because I chose to do X, Y or Z and I was like, I remember Pia and I were in our first like opera at this wonderful place called the NCPA in Bombay when we were like six. And that's something that no other six-year-old was doing. It's something we chose to do.

It's something we absolutely love and adored to do. But it was different and it was weird. My mom, so my mom kind of taught me how to sing.

She's an amazing singer and she teaches etiquette and grooming and personality development. And it does add up, doesn't it?

[Speaker 1] (37:50 - 37:52)

It does, it does.

[Speaker 3] (37:53 - 39:41)

So she was and my dad as well, you know, of course like school and college was really important to them. But they, from the get-go, from maybe when we were two and a half or three, we watched this ballet film which has just released called Billy Elliot. It's this wonderful musical and a film as well.

And it had just released and I remember Pia and I went to watch it. And Pia was really drawn to ballet even more than I was. And we ended up doing it for a majority of our lives.

I was never really sociable and okay with people because I always felt really judged for being maybe different or weird or whatever it is that they, you know, constantly called me growing up which led to a lot of more fear and more insecurity. Lots of people don't believe this when I say it because of the profession I'm now in. But it's taken a lot of really hard work to figure out how to actually hold my own and be myself without feeling that fear because both of us have also been raised to kind of be really proud of just everything that we've been a part of.

Like today I can, I'm 27 and I'm just like, wow, I did my first opera when I was seven years old. Like that's so cool. But when I was like 12, I would like hide and I wouldn't talk about it.

And, you know, things like that. And I took up theater very early in life because it was the stages and musical theater is something that I'm just still completely obsessed with. And I remember doing this musical called Grease.

It's a really fun musical. And that's actually when I kind of came into my own and I felt like, okay, this is something I really, really love to do because I, at that point, trained in singing all of my life, actually longer than I had done ballet. So I had like the music thing and the dance training and now the theater training to really figure out that that was possibly something that I wanted to do.

[Speaker 1] (39:41 - 39:44)

So no connection with Bollywood, but found your way there.

[Speaker 3] (39:44 - 39:45)

Yeah, none at all.

[Speaker 1] (39:45 - 39:46)

That must be hard, right?

[Speaker 3] (39:47 - 40:14)

It's very unusual. It's a very unusual place to be because most people that I know in my line of work have grown up watching Hindi films and I actually didn't, neither of us, neither my twin. So Disney had come to India just prior to that.

And I grew up being like a Disney baby, so many young girls and boys were an R. And I was the ambassador for Disney in India at the time as well.

[Speaker 1] (40:14 - 40:15)

How many R's a week?

[Speaker 3] (40:16 - 40:21)

It was like in my summer holidays, it was like for fun. They were like kind of not sure if that was something...

[Speaker 1] (40:21 - 40:22)

Did you get paid a wage?

[Speaker 3] (40:23 - 40:26)

I'm sure I did. I don't really remember.

[Speaker 1] (40:27 - 40:27)

Does that change you?

[Speaker 3] (40:28 - 40:29)

I don't think so.

[Speaker 1] (40:30 - 40:31)

If you start earning money at 16?

[Speaker 3] (40:32 - 41:11)

It depends on how you perceive that at that age and what your thought process is about, things like that. For me, it was just so much fun. And Disney is a fantastic organization to work with in any case.

Very particular and very mindful of how they treat people and children especially, obviously. And that was really, really fun. And it just, for me, it was just more time spent doing something that I grew up loving rather than being in a school and being made to feel really small.

I remember when it was time to sort of graduate from college. I met my team, what grew to be my team.

[Speaker 1] (41:11 - 41:12)

By team, what do you mean?

[Speaker 3] (41:12 - 41:34)

So in our industry, there are agents and in companies, there are agents, there are managers. And so I met my agent and the owner of a company called Matrix, Reshma Shetty. And she introduced me to Karan who became my guide and my mentor and the producer for my first film.

[Speaker 1] (41:35 - 41:37)

And how does it happen? How does somebody meet Karan?

[Speaker 3] (41:42 - 42:08)

I think it was a unique experience, again, to be honest with you. So I met with Reshma and she knew that I was doing a lot of stuff in the theater. She had come to the Royal Opera House where I hosted a concert.

And I think she spoke with Karan and Karan wanted to meet and of course we met and it was the most delightful first meeting ever. He asked me to sing in my first meeting with him. It was like...

[Speaker 2] (42:08 - 42:09)

Like on the spot?

[Speaker 3] (42:09 - 42:10)

Yeah, he was like so...

[Speaker 2] (42:10 - 42:15)

What did you sing? Are you going to sing for the theater today? No, no, no.

What did you sing? Nikhil, you want to ask me to sing on the spot?

[Speaker 3] (42:15 - 42:19)

I sang... So he and I both love a song. Which one?

In common, Lagja Gali.

[Speaker 5] (42:20 - 42:21)

We don't know it. Can you sing?

[Speaker 3] (42:21 - 42:36)

Full shape guys, I'll send you a link later. So yeah, that's... That was my first meeting and he said that they were writing a couple of scripts and they took a few months which was perfect because I was also soon to graduate.

[Speaker 1] (42:36 - 42:42)

How is it to like, you know, do a movie for the first time? How does it feel? You go on set and they're like act.

Is it like that?

[Speaker 4] (42:42 - 42:47)

It's like this Nikhil, where there are 500 people watching you and there's a mic on the side.

[Speaker 3] (42:48 - 43:44)

It didn't feel weird. Apart from the dance, but again because I had danced and I'm so much like theater and I had done the Disney stuff. I was like really accustomed to this kind of thing.

It also didn't feel invasive. It didn't feel weird. It didn't feel forced.

It didn't feel fake. Honestly, it didn't feel fake and that's something that I think, you know, a lot of people warn you about. And there have been experiences in my career and in my life which have felt fake.

So I'm aware of how to distinguish between okay, that was real and in retrospect, that actually wasn't. But that experience for me was... I can't think of a better way to have had a debut in such a tricky and a very interesting and unusual industry.

We all felt, and I can I think speak for everyone, we all felt very safe. We felt very happy and I think that's the only way to make a film is if you're genuinely just happy and having a good time. We were shooting all over the place and just, you know, every day kind of felt like a holiday.

[Speaker 1] (43:44 - 43:45)

How old were you first movie?

[Speaker 3] (43:45 - 43:49)

I was... I must have been 20 when we... 21 when we shot it.

[Speaker 1] (43:49 - 44:12)

It must be a really tough, competitive place to be, right? Bollywood. Because there are so few positions that so many people are competing for.

Like I'll give you an example of my work. I can build something. Adit can build something else.

KV can build something else. It's not like we're competing for the same pie. Unlike Bollywood where there can be maybe 20 actresses and 20 actors, right?

On top.

[Speaker 3] (44:12 - 44:30)

I mean, I... It also depends on what your definition of competition is. I feel like I genuinely can't think of...

Maybe that's because I grew up with a twin sister. I really keep thinking about this because a lot of us get asked this question a lot. In fact, it's more often than not the first question we're asked in an interview.

[Speaker 1] (44:30 - 44:31)

Which is?

[Speaker 3] (44:32 - 45:08)

About how competitive it is in a line of work like this. Sure, it is. It depends on what you see for yourself and how you really perceive that competition.

I genuinely don't think that there are... Till very recently there were boxes for everyone, right? Like she's this and she's that and then she's only this and she's only that and she can't be this because she's that.

There was always that sort of putting everyone in a box while a certain amount of that still exists. I do feel like I don't think any of us can truly do what the other does as well as the other does it. Everyone's figuring their own stuff out.

[Speaker 1] (45:09 - 45:10)

What's wrong with the industry overall?

[Speaker 3] (45:11 - 45:14)

That's a great question. You just went right into it.

[Speaker 2] (45:15 - 45:17)

You asked me like what's your last mile cost?

[Speaker 3] (45:18 - 45:19)

In what way do you mean?

[Speaker 1] (45:20 - 45:36)

Well, I mean in the sense that if a thousand rupees is going into making Bollywood movies the net outcome is sub-thousand rupees. Today. Oh really?

Well, it depends which film you're talking about. I'm talking about all the films together.

[Speaker 2] (45:36 - 45:38)

Are you talking about tier one? Like what are you using to segment?

[Speaker 1] (45:38 - 45:39)

Tier one, two, three, everything.

[Speaker 2] (45:39 - 45:42)

No, no, I'm saying what kinds of Bollywood films? Like the big production houses you're saying?

[Speaker 1] (45:43 - 45:44)

Doesn't matter. Everything put together.

[Speaker 2] (45:45 - 45:52)

Yeah, no, no. I'm trying to segment like indie stuff because indie stuff most of them will fail, right? The budget should also not be as high.

No, no, I'm saying most indie films would not...

[Speaker 1] (45:52 - 46:10)

Okay, let me reverse engineer this. If all the distribution is not growing at the pace that it once was that could be multiplex, single screens, streaming. Everybody's having a slightly bad time today with being able to monetize Bollywood in the manner they once could.

[Speaker 3] (46:10 - 46:21)

You know, I think it's because tastes are changing. Tastes have been changing for a while.

Maybe sometimes we haven't really listened to what people really want to see and what people really want to hear.

I feel a lot of it comes in the writing.

[Speaker 1] (46:21 - 46:28)

What do you think will work in the future? It's a really good question. How are tastes of your generation changing?

[Speaker 3] (46:29 - 47:45)

You know, till a few years ago and this is not to say that it doesn't exist anymore because there will always be that aspirational quality that we want to look at the movies and go to the movies to feel better and that's it. It's just how we are, right? As a people and as a world, not just in India.

But there is this certain aspirational quality that I feel that we felt very strongly about till quite recently with the launch of OTT platforms and this term relatability, right? That we all talk about so much as the young people of this country. I just feel like that has changed the game.

Wanting to look at whether it's dialogue, whether it's screenplay, whether that's performance, whether that's delivery, whether that's the way someone's styled on screen today, it all comes down to there's so much that goes into it, right? So I feel like when we start looking at the movies today, we care more for relatability rather than aspiration. That's a big gap that we've been figuring out how to fill and we have figured it out wonderfully in some of our projects and films, especially on OTT.

There's a lot more learning, I think, that a lot of us can do in terms of where stuff has really been missing.

[Speaker 1] (47:46 - 47:51)

If Tara had to make a movie next year, direct, produce and make it, what would you make it about?

[Speaker 3] (47:51 - 47:59)

So my next film is a film called Apoorva. It's the name of my character in the film. It's also my first solo-led film, which is something that's just really exciting.

[Speaker 1] (48:00 - 48:01)

Is it like a thriller? Is it a drama?

[Speaker 3] (48:01 - 48:22)

It is a survival drama of this young girl and she's put in this, God, it's so tricky not to say it, position that is very, very tricky and how she sort of uses her witter intelligence to save herself rather than being saved, which is something that we've seen for a long enough time in our movies.

[Speaker 1] (48:22 - 48:25)

Do you resonate with that a bit more than you should in real life?

[Speaker 3] (48:26 - 49:25)

Yeah, I think so. And I think a lot of young women and men will resonate with that and I hope that they do. It's not in a very preachy tone.

The film is very real. It's very raw. It's very different to anything that I've really done so far, which is why I'm so excited about it.

It's also, I don't look like myself in the film. I just don't. And But if I were to make a film, I think it would be, if not something in this space, it would be a musical.

I just feel like, in my last film, I sang for myself because I was playing a singer. But I would just, that's something that I would really like to do. If I could act in it, like you said, and direct it, I have a certain vision in mind.

[Speaker 1] (49:25 - 49:27)

Will that be relatable? A musical?

[Speaker 3] (49:27 - 49:30)

You can make it relatable. You can also make it aspirational.

[Speaker 2] (49:30 - 49:34)

Do you want to do a Hindi remake of one of the big Broadway ones?

[Speaker 3] (49:34 - 49:41)

I don't think you can do a Hindi remake. I think you can adapt certain elements from stories abroad because the experience is so different, right?

[Speaker 5] (49:41 - 49:41)

Sure.

[Speaker 3] (49:42 - 50:19)

Musical theatre there, musical theatre here. There are some fantastic plays here and musicals here in Hindi that I absolutely adore. But the experience is too different to remake.

So you can take inspiration from films. I don't know if you guys have ever seen Burlesque or seen films like that because you can do so much here. We were talking about the nightlife scene with jazz clubs and so much.

That was such a big, important part of the 80s and 70s and 90s actually in so many parts of India. If we can touch upon those subjects and topics and involve music as a people, we love great music. That's something that I'd love to do.

Nobody's doing it.

[Speaker 1] (50:19 - 50:22)

Describe Tara as a person. Same question I asked Navya.

[Speaker 3] (50:22 - 50:25)

I failed. Oh my god. Please succeed.

[Speaker 1] (50:25 - 50:32)

Like the innate, honest truth. See, we all have masks on.

[Speaker 3] (50:32 - 50:33)

Yeah, yeah.

[Speaker 1] (50:33 - 50:44)

I think when we talk about ourselves, the person is a mask. The more popular you are, I think there are more masks. So what is Tara?

Behind the mask.

[Speaker 4] (50:45 - 50:50)

Thank you so much. Thank you for that for us. I don't know where this is going.

[Speaker 2] (50:50 - 50:55)

We're becoming a tribe now. We can all finish each other. You guys gotta start getting involved in this.

[Speaker 4] (50:55 - 50:58)

I'm just making fun of everyone. I don't know why.

[Speaker 3] (51:00 - 51:06)

Oh, behind the mask. Gosh, I think not cool at all. Just not.

[Speaker 1] (51:07 - 51:07)

What is cool?

[Speaker 3] (51:07 - 51:15)

Can't ever be. You know the quintessential, like, I don't know any of these slang words that most people are using.

[Speaker 1] (51:15 - 51:17)

You think using slang words is cool?

[Speaker 3] (51:17 - 51:24)

This is exactly what I mean. I'm not cool. I don't even know what is cool.

I don't use slang words. Like, no, you know, like, anyway, I won't get into it.

[Speaker 1] (51:25 - 51:26)

Okay, not cool.

[Speaker 3] (51:26 - 51:40)

The music, like the music I listen to is What kind of music do you listen to? I listen to 50s, 60s, 70s. Yeah.

Jazz, R&B, pop.

[Speaker 1] (51:40 - 51:40)

Nice.

[Speaker 3] (51:41 - 51:43)

Essentially classical and semi-classical music.

[Speaker 1] (51:43 - 51:44)

What's wrong with the music of today?

[Speaker 3] (51:46 - 51:47)

Love it, love it.

[Speaker 1] (51:48 - 51:50)

You touched a nerve there.

[Speaker 3] (51:50 - 51:50)

No, lots of it is great.

[Speaker 1] (51:50 - 51:52)

Is it all like, drugs, sex and money?

[Speaker 3] (51:53 - 51:54)

No, I just don't resonate with it.

[Speaker 1] (51:54 - 51:55)

I know who the hip-hop songs are, right?

[Speaker 3] (51:55 - 51:57)

No, so many songs from the 80s and 90s are also about that.

[Speaker 1] (51:58 - 52:00)

I think KV and Adit dig that shit.

[Speaker 4] (52:00 - 52:00)

Do you?

[Speaker 2] (52:00 - 52:23)

My music is so great. Guys, think before you answer. So, my dad brought me up on like Dire Straits, Pink Floyd, The Doors, all of that.

I went to an Eric Clapton concert when I was like seven. And I was like, if I want to get girls, I need to learn how to play the guitar. Did you?

I did. I've been playing guitar for like 10-12 years. Are you good?

I'm a little bit rusty now. But I have like... Maybe you can play in Chicken Scene later.

Oh yeah, we'll get it done.

[Speaker 4] (52:23 - 52:26)

I play the piano, guys. I can join.

[Speaker 2] (52:27 - 52:28)

Yeah, and then they can all just watch.

[Speaker 4] (52:28 - 52:31)

Yeah, we can. It's like a little band. Oh my God, cute.

Love it.

[Speaker 1] (52:32 - 52:33)

We should make a band.

[Speaker 4] (52:33 - 52:36)

What is your contribution going to be, bud?

[Speaker 1] (52:36 - 52:38)

You can name it. You can name it. Backup singer.

[Speaker 4] (52:39 - 52:41)

Yeah, she'll be the...

[Speaker 1] (52:41 - 52:44)

Lead singer. Who is Tara as a person, really?

[Speaker 3] (52:46 - 52:47)

Really simple, I think.

[Speaker 1] (52:47 - 52:53)

Not cool in a weird way is a euphemism for cool. Because not wanting to be cool makes you cool.

[Speaker 3] (52:54 - 52:55)

Love that.

[Speaker 2] (52:55 - 52:59)

So profound. Yeah, like originally being cool was being counterculture.

[Speaker 1] (52:59 - 53:05)

What is cool? I think not giving, not caring, is cool.

[Speaker 3] (53:05 - 53:08)

That's what you relate. But caring is also very cool.

[Speaker 1] (53:08 - 53:11)

I think not caring about what you shouldn't care about is cool.

[Speaker 3] (53:11 - 53:15)

Absolutely agree. I'm confused now. This is why you should name the band.

[Speaker 1] (53:15 - 53:20)

This is why you should name the band. This is not for a talk. Yeah.

Okay, not cool then?

[Speaker 3] (53:23 - 53:36)

Like when I'm passionate about something, I'm deeply passionate about that thing. It's like if I watch a musical and I love a musical, I'll watch it 15 times and be obsessed by it. I'm just obsessive by nature.

I don't know if that's a Scorpio trait or whatever everyone says that it is.

[Speaker 1] (53:36 - 53:38)

Okay, not cool cool. Passionate.

[Speaker 3] (53:38 - 53:39)

Not cool cool.

[Speaker 1] (53:39 - 53:40)

Not cool cool.

[Speaker 3] (53:40 - 54:02)

Yeah, that's the one. Still introverted. Terribly shy.

Religious? We haven't been raised to be religious, to be honest with you. Appreciative of certain facets of certain religions, but haven't grown up to be religious actually at all.

[Speaker 1] (54:03 - 54:07)

Socialist, capitalist, communist? Undecided?

[Speaker 3] (54:08 - 54:13)

Undecided. In the middle, in the middle. I don't know.

I'm not definitive about.

[Speaker 1] (54:13 - 57:05)

We started today trying to establish what people in your generation are thinking, buying, doing. Because a lot of people like I are disconnected from a bulk of India, which is under the age of 30. So numbers.

Zero to 24 in India is 43% of our population. 24 to 44 is 31%. So I would assume below 30 is a good 50 to 60%.

Something on those lines. A lot of you do not live, breathe and go about your life in the manner that I did when I was 20 years old. Like cricket was a religion.

Bollywood was killing it. Shopping happened in person. Startups were new.

You know, back then this concept of venture capital in itself was a novel idea. If you had to start a company, you had to figure out a way to either borrow or make money from the very beginning. So I want to come to each one of you and kind of figure out what your thoughts are about consumption in general in your space.

I know I'm biased in my group because you guys are not the norm. But to a certain extent, what people buy, what people shop for, I think is driven by what is cool. And that funnel happens to be very top down.

So I think getting to know how you spend time, what you shop for, where you shop for it will be very interesting. So I was having dinner recently and I happened to be with somebody who runs a large fashion outlet, which aggregates fashion businesses. There was a guy who worked in e-commerce, CEO of an e-commerce brand.

There was a guy who worked in electric vehicles. And I was sitting over dinner and talking to each of them and they told me something has changed in India, wherein consumption has slowed

down drastically in the last one or two quarters. The numbers seem to show that Amazon is only growing by say 5% a year.

Flipkart is maybe growing at 7, 8% or near 10%. But based on the fact that Flipkart sells electronics of high value, which seem to be going. There is definitely a premiumization which is going on in the market where the top end seems to be doing well and spending more money.

But the middle and the bottom are not truly participating in the cycle of consumption. So to the Zepto brothers, you cater to the middle more so than other people in your position. What do you guys see on consumption?

I'm going to ask you about practice.

[Speaker 5] (57:05 - 57:07)

Yeah. Oh great, okay.

[Speaker 1] (57:07 - 57:08)

Okay, yeah.

[Speaker 2] (57:08 - 58:45)

No, so look, I think the... So I think what this generation gets that I think a lot of people haven't gotten, generations of the past haven't gotten is that good service does not mean premium or luxury. Like good service is now like table sticks.

And if you're not serving somebody well, that doesn't make you a budget player. It just makes you a player that's not seen very positively. So I think what this generation is going for is good high quality service at a reasonable cost.

On a budget, not necessarily something that they have to trade up for or something that's luxury. But they are more demanding in that way. Just because they're getting something for cheap, they're not willing to go through shit for it.

Traditionally, if you look at consumption the past couple of decades, if you're getting something of value as a consumer, usually you have to fight for it. I love DMart, by the way. But DMart is an example.

Right? Phenomenal business. But if you want to buy their products, it's a pain.

It's a fight. Right? You stand in line.

There's no proximity. You've got to drive there. Right?

It's crowded. Cashiers might not be available. It's just not like a good feeling.

Right? That's basically the cost of getting products for cheap. And that's been the philosophy before.

But now I think the way that this generation is thinking about consumption is how do I get that value but do it well in a way that's served well. So that's like our ethos a little bit. Are you seeing a change in rate of growth?

I mean, the base is higher. Like we used to grow 100% a week.

[Speaker 1] (58:47 - 58:50)

Compared to six months ago, how much are you growing it? Percentage-wise? Going faster.

[Speaker 2] (58:52 - 59:10)

With like, let's say, the same expansion rate and the same level of marketing we're actually growing a little bit faster. Some of it is because of structural efficiency. Some of it is because our customer experience is constantly improving.

Right? Like that. Always on improvement mode.

But we're not seeing anything structural that's holding us back.

[Speaker 5] (59:10 - 59:10)

Like in the market.

[Speaker 2] (59:10 - 59:25)

Those are more discretionary categories. Fashion. The vast majority of the categories we sell are non...

Not discretionary. It's like a lot of the day-to-day that you need to just run your house. Yeah, people perceive us to be discretionary.

But actually, when you become a Zepto customer...

[Speaker 1] (59:25 - 59:31)

You don't do any consumer durables, right? No capital goods, no consumer durables. Nothing with the long shelf life.

No, we do.

[Speaker 2] (59:31 - 59:41)

So we have home needs, right? Like, like moving from stationary to like... Yoga mats.

Yoga mats. Kitchen utensils. We do electronics.

So electronics is one of the fastest growing categories we have.

[Speaker 1] (59:41 - 59:43)

What is growing the fastest in electronics?

[Speaker 2] (59:44 - 59:51)

We're seeing the D2C electronics, the boards of the world, the noises of the world. Those are going really fast.

[Speaker 1] (59:52 - 59:54)

So you're competing with Flipkart there? Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (59:55 - 59:59)

I think we're not high value... Like, none of the super high value mobile phones and laptops and stuff.

[Speaker 1] (1:00:00 - 1:00:15)

Why isn't Flipkart doing this? Structurally, your model is... I know why Amazon can't compete, right?

Because they have one centralized warehouse where all the sourcing happens. Amazon buy, hold the inventory, then sell, and Flipkart connects.

[Speaker 2] (1:00:17 - 1:00:37)

They both are the same. Both are the same, yeah. They're the same model.

But their story publicly is different? Tactical difference. Still the same fundamentally.

To your question on why they aren't doing this, it's a good question. I don't know. There must be a logical answer to that.

In the last two years, the media or the general sentiment around... Don't give it away.

[Speaker 1] (1:00:38 - 1:00:38)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:00:38 - 1:00:43)

Has not been very positive. Everyone has written it off. Because globally also, most businesses...

[Speaker 1] (1:00:43 - 1:00:44)

You're talking about quick commerce?

[Speaker 2] (1:00:44 - 1:01:11)

Yeah. Globally, most quick commerce businesses have shut down by now. All the ones that went crazy in the zero interest rate 2020-2021 era.

It's like retail in that way. Most of them are shut down. What distinguishes Zepto?

Execution. Discipline. Rigor.

Like a lot more... We operate that Six Sigma culture. That's at least what we aspire to be.

If you read this book about Toyota.

[Speaker 1] (1:01:12 - 1:01:14)

Six Sigma Blackbird. Jay created it.

[Speaker 2] (1:01:14 - 1:01:28)

Yeah, we're trying to be like Toyota in that sense. We're a lot less... We're a lot more left brain.

We're a lot more analytical, a lot more disciplined. This business is about that. It's a lot of session with just better cost structures.

Like constantly improving it paisa by paisa.

[Speaker 1] (1:01:29 - 1:01:38)

No silver bullets. Right. So if I were 20 and I'm trying to build a business for 20 year olds in your domain, where do you think the gaps are?

[Speaker 2] (1:01:40 - 1:02:02)

Lots of gaps. I think the... Yeah, from our vantage point like on categories like we're the fastest growing commerce platform in the country right now.

So we can see like all these these different categories from makeup to electronics to like cold grocery. Like very boring answers is that there are commodities that should be branded that are not yet.

[Speaker 1] (1:02:03 - 1:02:05)

There's a big opportunity there. What do you mean by commodities?

[Speaker 2] (1:02:05 - 1:02:12)

Like I would say dry fruits. Basic example. There should be like a large-scale D to C dry fruits brand.

[Speaker 1] (1:02:13 - 1:02:16)

Are you also considering rice, atta, these are commodities?

[Speaker 2] (1:02:16 - 1:02:20)

Those were commodities until the Ashifads of the world made them into brands.

[Speaker 1] (1:02:20 - 1:02:22)

For atta maybe. For rice not yet, right?

[Speaker 2] (1:02:22 - 1:02:35)

True. Yeah, yeah. So there are brands now in those categories.

The vast majority... I'm not sure how vast that majority is. There's a fairly significant chunk that still buys loose atta, loose rice and things like that.

[Speaker 1] (1:02:35 - 1:02:42)

So you're saying one opportunity to build is creating IP or branding basic commodities.

[Speaker 2] (1:02:42 - 1:03:19)

Again the brand has to come from substance, right? If you just slap like a fancy logo. Give me an example of substance.

Ashifads. It's just cheaper and it's better quality. They've perfected the supply chain right through a lot of rigorous iteration.

Through a lot of boring process improvement and excellence. They've just created like this phenomenal supply chain of like I would say world class quality control. And they're able to pass on some condition to the customer in the form of lower prices and still print money.

That's great, right? That's an unbelievable equation. So that's where the substance comes from.

Now if you take like you take you know dry fruits and you put it in packaging and put a nice logo

on it.

[Speaker 1] (1:03:19 - 1:03:25)

Right, okay. Point noted. Tara, what are your shopping patterns?

Do you shop...

[Speaker 3] (1:03:25 - 1:03:25)

Oh dear.

[Speaker 1] (1:03:26 - 1:03:28)

Do you shop online? Do you shop...

[Speaker 4] (1:03:28 - 1:03:28)

I...

[Speaker 1] (1:03:28 - 1:03:29)

Where do you buy groceries?

[Speaker 3] (1:03:29 - 1:03:30)

You know, considering...

[Speaker 4] (1:03:31 - 1:03:32)

Hey, she's a...

[Speaker 1] (1:03:32 - 1:03:40)

She's a fan of Zepto. Putting it out there, guys. Did you look up if she shopped on Zepto before you came to the show?

[Speaker 5] (1:03:40 - 1:03:42)

No, she told us. I said, I told her.

[Speaker 1] (1:03:42 - 1:03:44)

When did you also look? When did I find out? I got some gossip.

[Speaker 2] (1:03:44 - 1:03:49)

Database, like... Tara's Tara orders on Zepto. No, on your own database.

[Speaker 3] (1:03:49 - 1:03:49)

She's on Zepto.

[Speaker 2] (1:03:50 - 1:03:50)

On her own database?

[Speaker 3] (1:03:51 - 1:03:52)

Yeah, totally he did that.

[Speaker 2] (1:03:52 - 1:03:52)

Wow.

[Speaker 3] (1:03:52 - 1:03:52)

Totally did that.

[Speaker 1] (1:03:53 - 1:03:53)

Yeah, Tara did that.

[Speaker 3] (1:03:54 - 1:04:16)

Shopping patterns, gosh. Till very recently, I was absolutely dreadful with my cellular like really bad. There's a reason my friends say oldie but a goldie when it comes to me.

Just really, really bad with most things on my phone. I am now much better at shopping online. A lot of my friends are comfortable shopping online.

[Speaker 5] (1:04:17 - 1:04:17)

Where do you shop?

[Speaker 3] (1:04:19 - 1:04:22)

I'm obsessed with interior design. So to be honest with you...

[Speaker 5] (1:04:22 - 1:04:23)

Gemsmiths?

[Speaker 3] (1:04:23 - 1:04:27)

A bunch of other brands. Okay.

[Speaker 1] (1:04:27 - 1:04:32)

Are you obsessed to the extent that you buy interiors and don't put it up anywhere? Just like in storage?

[Speaker 3] (1:04:32 - 1:05:01)

So I love to store beautiful things. I love beautiful things. I love creating beautiful things.

A lot of my furniture at home is designed by me. A lot of the stuff that is just on my table, scapes and stuff is designed by me. It's a space that I'm really excited to get into within the next year or so.

So honestly, a majority of what I shop is not even necessarily for my home. It's for future homes. It's for friends.

It's for... Where do you keep all this stuff? That's a great question.

We have a lot of space to... That's why I try to get one.

[Speaker 1] (1:05:02 - 1:05:05)

You're telling me, Dara, you have a go-down.

[Speaker 3] (1:05:06 - 1:05:08)

I don't have a go-down yet.

[Speaker 1] (1:05:08 - 1:05:08)

I ought to.

[Speaker 3] (1:05:09 - 1:05:21)

I ought to. I ought to with the amount of stuff that I... And also wherever I travel, I love collecting stuff that's reminiscent of that time and of that part of the world.

And anything vintage really.

[Speaker 1] (1:05:21 - 1:05:26)

So your friends when they shop, do they do it online or do they go to the store? I'm talking fashion.

[Speaker 2] (1:05:26 - 1:05:33)

Nikhil is trying to get at what do, you know, like what do interesting... How do interesting people

shop? Like are they shopping on Myntra?

Are they shopping on...

[Speaker 1] (1:05:33 - 1:05:37)

Also I want to know, are you buying large corporates or are you buying independent brands?

[Speaker 3] (1:05:37 - 1:05:39)

A mix of both. To be honest with you, a mix of both.

[Speaker 1] (1:05:39 - 1:05:45)

And what was that 10 years ago? 5 years ago? 5 years ago, Dara shopped...

I'll give you an example.

[Speaker 3] (1:05:45 - 1:06:14)

I needed to see and feel. I was one of those people that needed to see and feel in order to know... Because I'm also really particular about what I like and what I want to keep forever and ever because almost everything that I buy is something that I will keep for a very, very long time.

It also... I like to attach value to it because of that and it naturally tends to do that on its own. So whether that's art, whether that's just collectibles, whether that's vintage stuff, most of what I actually buy is things from another time.

[Speaker 2] (1:06:15 - 1:06:17)

But you can't buy online.

[Speaker 3] (1:06:17 - 1:06:23)

So for me, it's very individualistic and personal because I have to be present and I have to travel and I have to source.

[Speaker 2] (1:06:24 - 1:06:28)

But to your point, there is a lot more indie stuff that's getting bought, right?

[Speaker 3] (1:06:28 - 1:06:30)

Yeah, there's a lot more conversations about it, right?

[Speaker 2] (1:06:30 - 1:06:31)

It's a lot more personalized.

[Speaker 1] (1:06:31 - 1:06:39)

If you look at Vedu's numbers, Vedant is a friend of ours, common friend, who has a shoe platform called Main Street. Yeah. He'll be thankful we gave him a platform.

[Speaker 5] (1:06:39 - 1:06:40)

Give a shout out.

[Speaker 1] (1:06:41 - 1:06:58)

But his numbers seem to have shot up through the roof and I'm trying to wonder, I'm trying to figure out if people are getting disenfranchised by old school luxury and looking for something which is slightly more unique. Is that happening in your circles?

[Speaker 3] (1:06:58 - 1:07:00)

I definitely think so.

[Speaker 2] (1:07:00 - 1:07:05)

I'm a bit of an old soul that way. Like, I'm less like Vedant. Vedant keeps licking my shoes and just like…

[Speaker 1] (1:07:06 - 1:07:10)

But you know, in this iteration, my version of old school is like Louis Vuitton or something.

[Speaker 2] (1:07:10 - 1:07:11)

Yeah, it would be like…

[Speaker 1] (1:07:11 - 1:07:11)

See, but most people can't see.

[Speaker 2] (1:07:11 - 1:07:26)

It would be the nice, like the sort of finer, like European coast side kind of things in life. Yeah. But it's also a lower price point, right?

Like most 20 year olds probably can't afford Louis Vuitton but they might be able to afford a pair of like panda dogs or whatever.

[Speaker 4] (1:07:26 - 1:07:28)

What do I shop for? I don't shop…

[Speaker 2] (1:07:28 - 1:07:29)

And where do you shop?

[Speaker 4] (1:07:30 - 1:07:32)

I don't really shop more.

[Speaker 2] (1:07:32 - 1:07:32)

Zepto.

[Speaker 4] (1:07:34 - 1:08:01)

Yes, okay. There you go. I got my chances on Zepto.

No, I don't really shop. I think for me, consumption is more like for convenience. So I would say like a lot of my spending on consumption is like something I would utilise in my work.

I think fundamentally also, our generation is not one of ownership. We don't like owning things. We are more, you know, rent or do this like one or two times.

[Speaker 1] (1:08:01 - 1:08:02)

Would you do that with fashion? If somebody's willing?

[Speaker 4] (1:08:02 - 1:08:13)

Yeah, I'm not really somebody who's into fashion. So I'm not a, like I want to buy this pair of like shoes or this bag and keep it. I'm more that whatever's convenient for me.

[Speaker 1] (1:08:13 - 1:08:17)

Would you be open to renting a shoe and returning it? Or a jacket?

[Speaker 4] (1:08:17 - 1:09:00)

No, I'm more that person who just wear the same shoe for like five years. And then once it's like, like I'm not, I'm not an ownership kind of person. Like for me, it's more about like simplifying my day-to-day life and for it to be convenient for me.

So I spend a lot on content. I spend a lot on reading. I spend a lot when it, like I'm spending more so that I can simplify my day-to-day life through my work or through what I'm doing.

So for me, consumption is not so much. I'm not a big shopper. Is this a pattern?

Yeah, I think I don't think a lot of young people are investing in buying things because they don't necessarily like see the value. I mean, at least I don't see the value in that.

[Speaker 2] (1:09:00 - 1:09:01)

Like I'm not so sure.

[Speaker 4] (1:09:01 - 1:09:02)

I think it goes both ways.

[Speaker 2] (1:09:03 - 1:09:08)

There's a lot of people who have the aspiration. A lot of them. But there's that aspirational sort of this thing.

[Speaker 3] (1:09:09 - 1:09:20)

And yeah. And this rent thing is actually suddenly growing. Even, you know, in Bombay and I'm not sure about Delhi and other places, but I've heard about these websites.

Yeah, it started there.

[Speaker 4] (1:09:21 - 1:09:27)

There's clothes that you can rent. There's everything you can rent. Furniture, you can rent.

Clothes, you can rent.

[Speaker 2] (1:09:27 - 1:09:34)

But you know what? People are spending money on. I'm getting the sense that it's a little bit more sensible.

Like where people choose to be luxurious.

[Speaker 5] (1:09:35 - 1:09:35)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:09:35 - 1:10:11)

It used to be slightly frivolous. So you'd be luxurious on like an outfit or a nice car, which was just like more status or your home in a way, right? Like more status and like, and like in some cases ego.

Now what I'm seeing is, and you probably have like a lot more exposure to this, like people that

spend money, they're spending money on a lot more functional things. So I've seen people spending a lot of money on fitness. The most frugal people that I've met, they live like, they could be very wealthy, but they live like very standard lives.

But when it comes to their fitness, they will get like the best trainer, the best nutritionist, the best facilities, and they will go all out.

[Speaker 1] (1:10:11 - 1:10:29)

You know those numbers are terrible because I was doing some research on fitness. Yeah. Everybody who invested into fitness, I think we all overestimated the size of the sector.

While the change is happening in the very affluent sectors, like all of us here.

[Speaker 2] (1:10:29 - 1:10:30)

Yeah, sure.

[Speaker 1] (1:10:30 - 1:10:36)

But overall, people don't care that much about fitness yet in India.

[Speaker 4] (1:10:36 - 1:10:36)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:10:36 - 1:10:44)

Care about it enough to build a serious business there. But the trend seems to be it will go in that direction. Yeah.

But even like food, right?

[Speaker 2] (1:10:44 - 1:10:51)

Like food is also something that I'm seeing people focus on. But like, okay, I guess we're talking a little bit about like the luxury customer. Yeah.

Like what about like the…

[Speaker 4] (1:10:51 - 1:11:32)

I think for them, it's more experience driven. It's not more that I'm going to… It's more like you would invest or you would pay for an experience that you're not going to get in your day-to-day life.

And I'm not saying this for the 1% that's got access to those experiences every day. I'm saying for

somebody who's doing a nine-to-five job, you know, lower income background. For them, investing in an experience is more valuable for the entire family rather than…

So I feel that's what they're spending money on. So when you say that like films, I think that that for them is an outing. That we can take their family out all day.

You go to the mall, you eat at the food court, then you go watch a movie and then you go home. That for them is an experience. And that's something they're willing to spend money on.

[Speaker 2] (1:11:32 - 1:11:55)

So that's interesting. Like what do you think about… So you guys should have some perspective.

Like what do you guys think about films in India and like the distribution of films? Like if I'm… Like what's the future of the way people watch films?

Is it just going to be OTT? Does like… Do the PVRs of the world still have legs to grow?

Or do like… What do you guys think? Like from a consumption perspective, what do people our age want?

[Speaker 3] (1:11:55 - 1:12:27)

You know, I really don't think you can… It's just something you can't replace. That experience of…

And as a people, it's something… You know, love OTT. I love OTT platforms.

I love watching stuff on OTT platforms. All of us do, right? But there's just something that you just can't take away about that experience that we've all grown up loving.

All age groups. Anybody and everybody. The food aspect of it.

The fact that you can actually come together as a community and a society and actually not have very many differences for a change.

[Speaker 5] (1:12:27 - 1:12:27)

Yeah.

[Speaker 3] (1:12:27 - 1:12:42)

And just sit together, be together for those two or three hours and just forget everything that could possibly be worrisome that day. And there's so much to be worried about, especially in the last few years. I feel like…

I can't wait for people to go back to the cinemas and they are slowly flocking back.

[Speaker 2] (1:12:42 - 1:12:46)

No, it's interesting. But it's like… But like, you know, for the people that are in a tier three or a tier four city.

[Speaker 3] (1:12:46 - 1:12:47)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:12:47 - 1:12:55)

What about those folks? Have they gone through PVR kind of experience? In their…

Like, even in the past. Like, they would not… You're on Arshnik's content episode.

[Speaker 3] (1:12:55 - 1:13:00)

You know, so I probably wouldn't be the right person to comment on that because I haven't had that experience.

[Speaker 1] (1:13:00 - 1:13:41)

So, I'll give you some data. Okay. Yeah, yeah.

I've been an investor in PVR for a long, long time. Yeah. The thesis in India broadly was, in America, the penetration of multiplexes.

So, in India broadly, there are 9,000 screens. About 2,000 of them happen to be multiplex screens. The access to a multiplex in America is something like for every 30 to 40 people, there's one multiplex or access.

Oh, wow. I'm talking 30 to 40 from all directions. Yeah.

That number in China is probably one-tenth of that. But in India, that number happens to be one-hundredth of that.

[Speaker 2] (1:13:41 - 1:13:41)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:13:42 - 1:14:36)

So, a lot of people assumed that a movie-watching experience in a safe, clean, air-conditioned environment for a family would be so appealing that a lot more people will go watch movies. But

that transition and that increased penetration in tier two and three has not happened for many reasons. A lot of these are very technical in nature.

Like, we started a company to set up theatres in tier two, three towns. I'll give you some details. Each theatre, two screens, 60 and 40, tickets at about 150 rupees.

In between the two screens, there would be like a grocery store, community centre kind of a concept. At 60-70% occupancy, one and a half crore capex per centre, we assumed we would break even in X amount of time. 60-70% utilisation, break even?

[Speaker 2] (1:14:36 - 1:14:43)

In two, three years' time. But you would want that percent to be lower, right? Because you want to make, you want to break even at 40 and then make money all the way to 100.

[Speaker 1] (1:14:43 - 1:14:54)

It's a factor of time. If you were to take 60 down to 40, then take it to three years, four years, five years. Makes sense.

It's a factor of how much time you're willing to put into it. But regulation in India is quite cumbersome.

[Speaker 5] (1:14:54 - 1:14:55)

Okay.

[Speaker 1] (1:14:55 - 1:15:53)

Around, I mean, it's a good and a bad thing. There have been disasters in India around fire, safety and stuff like that. But to display movies in that manner, you need to take care of those regulations which make the cost prohibitive in a way.

So the new thing we're, new thing multiplexes are exploring in India because now there is one incumbent, right? INOX and PVR have merged. I think they're thinking about how to premiumize the experience like in everything else.

So the point I'm trying to get at is every sector outside of groceries, because you guys are here, premiumization seems to be what is selling. I think people are coming to this decision that we arrived at this number for content business. We thought India has about 10 million people who will pay $10 a month and over to consume content, any kind of content.

[Speaker 2] (1:15:53 - 1:15:54)

That's 800 rupees.

[Speaker 1] (1:15:54 - 1:16:34)

800 rupees. About 40 million people will pay $1 and upward for consuming some kind of content. The rest of India will largely not be willing to pay to consume content.

So our hypothesis has very much been, not ours, but just society at large and companies and corporations. There are 50 million people in India that you're truly building a product for if you're going down the premiumization route. And the more premium you go, the higher the rate of growth seems to be.

That could be a factor of income inequality. That could be a factor of.

[Speaker 2] (1:16:35 - 1:16:55)

But by premium, what do you mean? Like, do you mean higher prices or better experience? Both.

They come hand in hand. So I'm like slightly, I'm slightly cagey about the former. I think the higher price part, at least when we look at our business, people just won't pay.

Like groceries are different. I guess so.

[Speaker 1] (1:16:55 - 1:16:59)

Groceries are essentially good and I'm talking about all discretionary stuff. But even for the service, right?

[Speaker 2] (1:17:00 - 1:17:16)

Like 10 minute delivery. You know, people tell me, so we've gone through this phase, right? 10 minute delivery is impossible.

Nobody cares about 10 minute delivery. Phase two, the phase when we got past that, phase three, 10 minute delivery will not make any money. Which we're also getting past, right?

[Speaker 1] (1:17:16 - 1:17:28)

But the, in that second phase. What scale does 10 minute delivery make money? What percentage of the population is using apps such as Zepto to shop?

Very small.

[Speaker 2] (1:17:28 - 1:17:39)

Very, very small. Basis points. What's the number?

It would be, I mean like, to give you the exact number, it would be like about today, collectively,

0.3% of grocery.

[Speaker 1] (1:17:40 - 1:17:56)

30 pips. What number does it have to go up to before quick commerce makes money? 0.35. So you're close. Yeah. Is that a big part of how you make money or is it more increasing the value of order?

[Speaker 2] (1:17:57 - 1:17:59)

Right now, it's more that though.

[Speaker 1] (1:18:00 - 1:18:01)

Increasing the value of order?

[Speaker 2] (1:18:01 - 1:18:11)

Most of our apps are not making money. It's a matter of getting more dark stores. Launching more dark stores.

Getting them to that point where overheads are covered. You know, to be honest, most of our stores make money today.

[Speaker 5] (1:18:11 - 1:18:11)

Right.

[Speaker 2] (1:18:13 - 1:18:34)

And yeah, like now people are starting to internalize that whole shit. These stores are starting to make, you know, throw up like pretty meaningful amounts of cash. But anyway, so like coming back to it, I think like, I don't know if people are still willing to pay.

I think that inherent sense of frugality in India is still deep-seated. I think the problem statement is, how do you give them that experience without the cost?

[Speaker 1] (1:18:35 - 1:18:42)

Do you think the ecosystem got spoiled by cheap foreign money, which came in and artificially discounted everything last 2-3 years?

[Speaker 2] (1:18:42 - 1:18:43)

100%.

[Speaker 1] (1:18:43 - 1:18:44)

But not just the customer.

[Speaker 2] (1:18:45 - 1:18:47)

You know, it's not even just about the customer. It's about the operators.

[Speaker 1] (1:18:48 - 1:18:48)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:18:48 - 1:18:50)

The operators got spoiled, not the customer.

[Speaker 1] (1:18:50 - 1:19:00)

And do you think a lot of what is happening is a factor of money becoming more expensive? I'm talking about the cycle. Inflation, high interest rates, money is expensive, less money in India.

[Speaker 2] (1:19:00 - 1:19:16)

In the discussion you talked about, like the people you met. In fashion or whatever. Potentially.

200% agree with that. Like, that is absolutely what's happening. There's nothing structural if you look at the Indian economy.

That's putting anybody back. It's what's happening abroad that's hurting us. To that point, right?

All dollars should come from India.

[Speaker 1] (1:19:17 - 1:19:32)

Right. Okay, next question. Instagram sold as much as 44 million blue ticks.

Mostly to people in the age group of 18 to 34. In India? No, across the world.

They made something like 600, 700 million in a day.

[Speaker 3] (1:19:32 - 1:19:33)

My God.

[Speaker 1] (1:19:34 - 1:20:01)

Wow, that's crazy. How important... I know this happened in China 10-20 years ago.

The perception of you on social media started becoming more important than the real you. Yeah.

I know this is prevalent in the age group of 30 to 35.

Like my age, people also really care for this. But is that number significantly higher for 20 to 30? Probably.

[Speaker 3] (1:20:01 - 1:20:05)

Yeah, probably. Yeah. And slightly under, I would also say.

Slightly under 20.

[Speaker 2] (1:20:05 - 1:20:07)

Yeah, brother's 15. Honestly.

[Speaker 4] (1:20:08 - 1:20:14)

I mean, there's consuming Instagram at what, 12, 13 now? It's not even... Sometimes even younger, honestly.

[Speaker 2] (1:20:14 - 1:20:19)

My brother's 15. I think he got onto Instagram probably like 11 or 12.

[Speaker 1] (1:20:19 - 1:20:19)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:20:20 - 1:20:24)

He lives in Dubai. TikTok is not banned in Dubai. So it's like heavy.

[Speaker 1] (1:20:24 - 1:20:26)

And you think this trend will continue?

[Speaker 2] (1:20:26 - 1:20:28)

Yeah. I don't see any reason why it won't.

[Speaker 1] (1:20:29 - 1:20:40)

So you think for somebody building a business for Gen Z, how do they serve the need for validation that seems inherently ingrained in Gen Z?

[Speaker 2] (1:20:40 - 1:20:46)

So it's a bit of art and science. So I don't know if you've seen this. There's this guy called Nikita Beer.

[Speaker 1] (1:20:46 - 1:20:46)

No.

[Speaker 2] (1:20:46 - 1:21:47)

So he's... Oh yeah. So he's a founder in the US.

He started this company a couple of years ago called Gas App or something like that. Which was like an anonymous... Like I don't know if you guys saw this ever.

Sort of this whole TBH phase of like posting on like Ask.fm. Like something in that vein. So basically like you could anonymously post. Anonymously compliment people in your school.

So it was like very hyper or whatever. He sold it to Facebook. Right.

And because it hit and it blew up basically. In a couple of months, millions of like school kids in the US got on it. Facebook bought it.

He had to stay at Facebook for a couple of years because like after the acquisition, that's what the lock-in was. He started another company after that. And the exact same playbook and the same thing got replicated.

He sold it again to Discord for like tens of millions of dollars. So some amount of this can probably be gamed. Right.

And like this guy, for example, has figured it out. He's had two very successful exits in like five years. Playing on that exact sort of dopamine concept for even people younger than 20.

[Speaker 1] (1:21:47 - 1:22:00)

But how do you, how does someone's new cell dopamine? I'll ask Tara and Navya this question. If I want to build something which will provide this artificial sense of validation, what do I build today?

[Speaker 4] (1:22:00 - 1:22:41)

I think it's something that's recognition based. Being recognized, being appreciated, being... Like a positive feedback?

Yeah, positive feedback or a response from a celebrity, like a DM. I think a lot of people would pay to get a reply from someone just so they could show like 10 other people that they got a

reply. Yeah, it's like someone likes your post.

You're like, oh, this person liked my post. I think it's that. It's recognition, appreciation and validation for your content.

I'm not saying like it has to be a random thing like you're a dancer, you're a musician, you've, you know, someone famous has shared your, you know, piece of work. I think that is something people would probably pay for.

[Speaker 3] (1:22:41 - 1:22:42)

Yeah, I do agree with you.

[Speaker 2] (1:22:43 - 1:22:52)

Like this, like False Cassidy, right? There was this new restaurant that opened up in Mumbai. If you order an Indian accent, it's in Delhi as well.

Very nice, phenomenal place, by the way.

[Speaker 1] (1:22:53 - 1:22:55)

That's working everywhere in the world, by the way.

[Speaker 2] (1:22:55 - 1:22:55)

Right.

[Speaker 1] (1:22:55 - 1:23:09)

Do you think that'll work for Gen Z? I think brands are being arrogant and arrogance as a sales strategy is working. So if people go to a brand and ask for something and they say, no, you can't have it.

People want it more.

[Speaker 2] (1:23:09 - 1:23:42)

Like Swatch, like the Omega Swatch. They're building a great business. Okay.

The industry is built on scarcity, right? Like back, it's not as popular anymore. But like when I was in school, Supreme, which is like this New York skin brand, they've been around for 20 years.

But at some point they figured out if we actually just limit the amount of stuff that we sell and do limited drops, that creates this whole secondary market for it. And there's a lot of hype created. And so that entire industry is this one.

So like, okay. So false scarcity and like peer validation from the recognition.

[Speaker 1] (1:23:42 - 1:23:58)

What's a good marketing way? Like what is working to nudge a Gen Z to buy a certain brand? In my time, it used to be TV.

I like how I'm talking like a 70 year old, a few years ago, it would be TV ads. It would be newspaper ads.

[Speaker 2] (1:23:58 - 1:24:03)

It would be, you know, like Instagram ads today, probably. Credibility. It used to be credibility.

[Speaker 1] (1:24:04 - 1:24:05)

Is Instagram still valid?

[Speaker 2] (1:24:06 - 1:24:09)

Instagram ads do pretty well. For us, no, no, no. No, they don't.

[Speaker 4] (1:24:09 - 1:24:12)

I shop a lot on Instagram. Yeah, we do.

[Speaker 2] (1:24:12 - 1:24:14)

Instagram doesn't do well for us. I mean, like when we spend money.

[Speaker 4] (1:24:14 - 1:24:36)

Like if I'm buying like clothes, I would say like 90% of what I shop is through like Instagram ads. And not known brands. Do you see them?

No, they would come up and I'd go down this loophole of like. Like there's this page on Instagram called Local Nation that I follow and it's like local brands. And I get stuck in a loophole.

[Speaker 1] (1:24:36 - 1:24:39)

And how's the shopping experience? You see it on Instagram then?

[Speaker 4] (1:24:39 - 1:24:49)

You see it, you click on the post, it takes you to the website of the brand and you check out. It'll say new shop or it'll say new website. It'll say buy now and you go straight to the website.

And that is where I do 90% of my shopping.

[Speaker 2] (1:24:50 - 1:24:55)

TikTok in the US has a very large e-commerce article which is basically this.

[Speaker 4] (1:24:55 - 1:24:55)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:24:55 - 1:25:01)

So you see a TikTok which is like blown up and directly from there view the products that this person is wearing. This is a t-shirt, okay?

[Speaker 4] (1:25:01 - 1:25:01)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:25:01 - 1:25:02)

Buy it.

[Speaker 1] (1:25:03 - 1:25:17)

Somebody's building for Gen Z's shopping habits. Do you think things like this? Like what we're doing now.

If Tara was wearing a certain watch or Adit's wearing a certain shirt, this is a better place to sell than Instagram?

[Speaker 4] (1:25:17 - 1:25:28)

No, like I'm watching a show. I don't know if many people do this. Like if I'm watching a show and like the show is inside someone's house, I'm looking at the carpet or I'm looking at the table and I'm like, I want that.

[Speaker 3] (1:25:28 - 1:25:30)

Yeah, like where do I get that?

[Speaker 4] (1:25:30 - 1:25:30)

How do I get that?

[Speaker 3] (1:25:30 - 1:25:31)

Why?

[Speaker 4] (1:25:31 - 1:25:39)

Most people actually shop. Yeah, like I'm looking at, okay, she's wearing this. Like great.

The content is great and all that. But I'm looking at things going on in the back. Like, okay, which hotel is she at?

[Speaker 1] (1:25:39 - 1:25:42)

Like what cafe is this?

[Speaker 4] (1:25:42 - 1:25:44)

What pastry is this?

[Speaker 1] (1:25:44 - 1:25:48)

And you're much more likely to shop like that versus an ad thrown at you.

[Speaker 4] (1:25:48 - 1:26:00)

Yeah, because you're, that's for some reason it feels like that's not being pushed at you. You're choosing to watch that piece of content. And if you're watching that piece of content and you're interested in what's being shown to you, then yes, tell me where I can buy that.

[Speaker 1] (1:26:01 - 1:26:10)

And is that discoverability in a way effort on your part? And that makes you press the trigger? Because you made an effort in discovering a certain thing.

[Speaker 4] (1:26:10 - 1:26:20)

No, it's somehow for me, subconsciously, it's like, oh, I wasn't going to this to buy something. I was going to either be educated, to be entertained, or just to generally consume.

[Speaker 2] (1:26:20 - 1:26:23)

Influencer marketing is basically the same thing, right? You open Instagram.

[Speaker 4] (1:26:23 - 1:26:46)

I don't know how effective that will be in like four or five years because now practically everyone is an influencer. So I feel like it's the more, at least in my mind, it's the more organic way of purchasing when you're watching a piece of content. And like, it's something I genuinely do.

Like I see some location, I'm like, what cafe is this? Like what noodles are they eating? Like where are they?

[Speaker 2] (1:26:46 - 1:26:55)

For example, let's say Adit posts something on Instagram, which is like, okay, he's at this nice restaurant. And you see the dish there, right? And you're like, oh wow, this is a nice looking restaurant.

[Speaker 4] (1:26:55 - 1:26:55)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:26:55 - 1:26:58)

And he's tagged the location there. And that's how you sort of…

[Speaker 4] (1:26:58 - 1:27:05)

But I'm, I don't know, I feel like I see that every day. Like if I'm watching a piece of content, this is something that…

[Speaker 2] (1:27:05 - 1:27:06)

There's too much noise there. Yeah.

[Speaker 4] (1:27:06 - 1:27:13)

This is, in a way to me, it seems more organic and more genuine than…

[Speaker 3] (1:27:13 - 1:27:51)

I do feel like though with older generations, like even, you know, I would say 40 and above, it's easier. And I've noticed this with a bunch of folks that I know. When they see the ads on Instagram and they're scrolling, they actually, even if they don't really know how to go through the whole process of going and actually buying so-and-so item, they actually figure it out and they manage to do it.

Because it's so easy now on Instagram and all of these sites, right? You just click on something. It'll say, go to website or go to shop or view shop or something.

Click on that. Your item is right in front of you. Buy.

This is what it's for. Buy. Credit card details.

Done.

[Speaker 1] (1:27:51 - 1:27:54)

Does everybody in Gen Z have a credit card? Is that the means of shopping?

[Speaker 2] (1:27:54 - 1:27:55)

What is Gen Z age again?

[Speaker 1] (1:27:55 - 1:27:58)

In my textbook, below the age of 30.

[Speaker 2] (1:27:58 - 1:28:00)

There's no starting point.

[Speaker 1] (1:28:00 - 1:28:02)

I would say starting point is 18 to 30.

[Speaker 4] (1:28:02 - 1:28:03)

No, I don't think so.

[Speaker 2] (1:28:03 - 1:28:04)

No, no.

[Speaker 1] (1:28:04 - 1:28:09)

They don't have a credit card. So how are they shopping? On streaming, on social media, on Instagram?

UPI?

[Speaker 4] (1:28:09 - 1:28:16)

UPI. Yeah. I use GPA for…

I don't use a credit card. I don't use cash. I use UPI for everything.

Why?

[Speaker 2] (1:28:16 - 1:28:17)

It's easier.

[Speaker 4] (1:28:17 - 1:28:28)

It's just easier. I use it for ordering stuff online. I use it for food.

I use it for an Uber. I'd use it for, even if I'm going to buy like an ice cream on the road. I don't carry cash.

I don't carry a card.

[Speaker 1] (1:28:28 - 1:28:34)

From a financial lens, a credit card is giving you interest-free credit for 30 days.

[Speaker 4] (1:28:34 - 1:28:37)

I know, but I'm choosing convenience over…

[Speaker 1] (1:28:37 - 1:28:39)

Or having to remember to pay a credit card.

[Speaker 2] (1:28:39 - 1:28:49)

But you know that interest-free… So the thing is, with UPI, the vendor ecosystem is so much better. So the amount of, which she just mentioned, getting ice cream on the road, the Uber driver, he won't accept a credit card.

[Speaker 4] (1:28:49 - 1:28:49)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:28:50 - 1:28:51)

So you're just blocked.

[Speaker 4] (1:28:51 - 1:28:56)

You're just automatically ingrained into thinking that this is just the best and fastest way to…

[Speaker 1] (1:28:57 - 1:29:02)

So what we're saying is, if you're building a business for Gen Z, UPI is your go-to payment.

[Speaker 4] (1:29:03 - 1:29:03)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:29:03 - 1:29:12)

Content is going to be part of the communication, part of the narrative. Is there one social media app which is more relevant today than others? Up until we become like China.

[Speaker 4] (1:29:12 - 1:29:21)

It depends on the demographic you're looking at. If you're looking at a younger demographic, I would say Instagram. If you're looking like my mom, then like Facebook.

And if you're looking at my grandmom, then YouTube.

[Speaker 2] (1:29:22 - 1:29:22)

What do we think about like…

[Speaker 4] (1:29:23 - 1:29:41)

Really? Yeah. My grandmom literally serves YouTube.

But my mom will serve… Like if you look at any mom in the country, she'll be on Facebook watching fake news. And if you look at a Gen Z there on Instagram, my grandmom every day is like, oh, I saw this on YouTube.

And I'm like, who here watches YouTube? And she's like, I do. So it's really…

[Speaker 3] (1:29:42 - 1:30:25)

No, no, no. I actually think that so many people from an older generation have switched to Instagram. Like it's just so convenient.

There's something that attracts all age groups to Instagram. I think it's the convenience of it and the availability of you can shop on it. You can get entertained by it.

You can watch brief videos. You can watch long videos. You can watch talks.

You can hear seminars. You can listen to music. You can watch someone dancing.

You can hear your favorite celebrity talk about something cool. You can see branded content. It's just offering you everything with just doing that.

So, and I feel like it's entertainment for like hours and hours. And that's why there's this continuous scrolling, even in an age group like my mom's age group. And I see it and I'm like, oh my God, we're the same.

[Speaker 1] (1:30:25 - 1:31:27)

What do you guys think of from a Gen Z perspective of society? Wage growth has largely lagged

asset price growth. So let's assume in India, salaries are growing by 5%.

But assets like your home, your equity, whatever investment you have is growing at 10%. As long as that is the case, the wealthy will continue to get wealthier because they have the assets which are growing faster. How do you guys see that world?

How do you, I know, I know you come from a fairly, I would not like to say how privileged, how whatever. But I think it's fair to say everyone here is from a privileged background. And I think there's no point making it look like that is a bad thing.

You're a circumstance of where you're born. And I don't think anybody can judge you for that. I think just life, right?

But how do you think of income inequality in the ecosystem?

[Speaker 2] (1:31:27 - 1:31:37)

The answer to this is like employees, and we do this with pretty much everybody on the team, employees owning some piece of equity. That's hard to scale. No, you get to like, you get to like.

[Speaker 1] (1:31:37 - 1:31:45)

And that is very subjective to startups, companies which are starting to grow, which is a very microcosm of.

[Speaker 2] (1:31:45 - 1:32:04)

If you're creating value, what you can do with your profit, there should be some limitation there. Like if you look at pre 80s in the US, you didn't have the ability, you had very strict regulation on share buybacks.

[Speaker 1] (1:32:06 - 1:32:17)

Tell me broadly in society, there is income inequality, current situation, this will continue to rise. What does the government do? A, how does the Gen Z feel about it?

You said.

[Speaker 2] (1:32:18 - 1:32:42)

Yeah, look, see, I mean, to be honest with you, if you want to say broadly, it's like a sweeping, like it's sweeping enterprise reform, right? Like antitrust laws, right? That's one, that's one of the levers, right?

Antitrust, like what I just mentioned on like, you know, giving value back to employees on like, yeah, and to an extent tax, right? But then the tax itself, slightly suspecting, what does a tax

accomplish?

[Speaker 1] (1:32:42 - 1:33:02)

Maybe you don't have to frame it as taxing an entrepreneur, but you could say property taxes. Yeah, inherited wealth, not taxes on taxes that will disincentivize people to earn an extra amount of money today, but taxes on money that has been in the equation for a long time.

[Speaker 2] (1:33:02 - 1:33:15)

Actually, the answer to the question, though, on a side note is like entrepreneurship. You create more entrepreneurship. I think that's a good answer.

Result zero sum. Yeah, I think that's a good answer. Like the more entrepreneurship, the more wealth creation by default.

You want to optimize that also to make it more.

[Speaker 1] (1:33:16 - 1:33:21)

And tax in such a manner that entrepreneurs are encouraged left, right and center.

[Speaker 4] (1:33:21 - 1:33:25)

But how are you going to go about creating entrepreneurship?

[Speaker 1] (1:33:26 - 1:34:13)

Nikhil? No, I have an answer to this. Tax property, precedent in America.

If you live in Connecticut, you pay almost one and a half, two percent property tax. Most of India's ill-gotten wealth somehow finds its way into property. This is going to sound bad, but I don't think farming income above a certain threshold should be subject to no tax because a lot of people use that loophole to do other things.

And inheritance tax precedent again in the UK, in the US. Take all the money which comes from this. Increase the quality of education that is given out for free.

Help entrepreneurship.

[Speaker 4] (1:34:14 - 1:34:17)

I'm saying how do you how do you encourage entrepreneurship in younger people?

[Speaker 1] (1:34:18 - 1:34:20)

How do you inculcate them or how do you facilitate them?

[Speaker 4] (1:34:21 - 1:34:37)

I mean, if you're saying the solution is entrepreneurship and 24 to 30 or whatever is 60 percent of the population, then how do you how do you position entrepreneurship as an aspirational career for a 24 year old?

[Speaker 1] (1:34:38 - 1:34:39)

I think we're doing that a little bit right now.

[Speaker 4] (1:34:40 - 1:35:33)

No, but I'm saying that the reality for say, like we may be different. I'm saying the reality for tier two, tier three is that, you know, their parents have spent a certain amount of money on an education. They graduate, they either do MBA, they go into engineering or whatever stream they're in.

They graduate and their immediate thought is not that I'm going to take a financial risk and start a company, but I'm going to work for 10 years, get a stable income and then maybe pay my parents back. Then once I get, you know, up to a certain level of salary, then maybe I will think about doing this on the side, see if that works and then maybe switch to that if I see that this is something I can do risk free. I don't know if that is, at least that's what I feel is the mindset of a lot of college students today.

They're not willing to take that risk.

[Speaker 1] (1:35:33 - 1:36:29)

If instead of the social cause that we all choose to come together on, a lot of people come together and choose causes around funding young, bright people who want to start a business with not necessarily risk to reward in mind. That's an example. And even in the current ecosystem, you know, there are so many outliers.

Like I started earning a wage. I used that money to start trading. I used that trading money to do other things in life when I started from a certain point, which is near zero.

So the opportunities do exist. What I think we should do also in society is sell the narrative of being an entrepreneur. Up until now, our role models in society were actors, they were cricketers.

You're talking about roles where India can have 11 cricketers who played for the Indian team growing up.

[Speaker 4] (1:36:30 - 1:36:54)

To your point, I think also selling the narrative of entrepreneurs, but selling the narrative of not what the conventional entrepreneur has been for the longest time, but who entrepreneurs really are today, which are 19, 20 year old kids. It could be a 50 year old housewife. It could be really anyone.

So I'm saying that selling that narrative is going to work more than selling the narrative of, you know, a founder who works in.

[Speaker 1] (1:36:55 - 1:36:56)

Not just them, but both of you.

[Speaker 4] (1:36:56 - 1:37:30)

Unconventional entrepreneurs. That's what we need to sell. Not just that characteristic that we've always had or that stereotype that you had for an entrepreneur for the last 10 to 15 years.

It has to be more in tune with what the reality is. And I think today, entrepreneurs go wider than just, you know, startup founders. And what we do, I think that, you know, there are a lot of other definitions of what that is today in India.

And I think that's what needs to be sold. Yeah. So that people know that there is more than just that one stereotype of what entrepreneurship is.

[Speaker 1] (1:37:30 - 1:37:36)

I think five boys are going to watch this today. And they're going to look at these two kids. And they're going to be like…

[Speaker 2] (1:37:36 - 1:37:38)

It's a boy's kid. He's turning 21.

[Speaker 1] (1:37:38 - 1:37:54)

And they're going to be like, wait, they applied for a fund and got 40 lakhs to attempt to build a business. They said the name of the fund. You know, people will look that up.

The idea for us to help the ecosystem is create more funds like that. Something you should take a chance.

[Speaker 2] (1:37:54 - 1:38:41)

Something you should do. So Sam Altman. Yeah.

At this, you know, Sam Altman, right? So OpenAI, Chad GPT, founder of that company. He has

this podcast or like a whatever.

It's on YouTube. I guess it's a podcast with Jack Collison or Patrick Collison from Skype. And within that, one of the things that he was like some that Sam said, something I've always wanted to do, haven't had the time to do it, is to pick out like a hundred of the smartest kids and normally would go work like some random job at a Google because of the stability.

And say, I'll give you, I mean, it's US terms. You can like do the translation to India. But I'll give all of you a hundred thousand dollars, a year, for 10 years.

With that, do whatever you want. Right? So that at least that pressure of, okay, I need to work at a job is done.

He has a means to do it. You should think about doing something like this.

[Speaker 1] (1:38:41 - 1:39:06)

No, no, we are. We're planning the center where there's no educational requirement. We'll have our own process to get people in.

We will train them with people who voluntarily give time like all of us and many other friends of mine. We will house them. We will kind of like teach them about not what the syllabus of a college might be, but what technology and the skill sets that we think are relevant.

[Speaker 4] (1:39:07 - 1:39:07)

Yes.

[Speaker 1] (1:39:07 - 1:39:11)

I can fund it to a certain extent, but I'm going to go out to my friends and ask for help.

[Speaker 4] (1:39:11 - 1:39:40)

Unfortunately, our education system gears us towards getting 95% or 94% in our exams rather than on, you know, skills that we would actually use when we enter the workforce or when you are actually managing a company or working in a startup. And those are the softer skills that we talk about. And that's not emphasized on or taught.

It's very marks oriented and outcome oriented rather than experience. And I think that's something that we have to.

[Speaker 1] (1:39:41 - 1:39:59)

I agree with you 100%. I think conformity has been beaten down upon us by our predecessors for whom that worked. I think the one big takeaway everybody building for Gen Z can take is being

conformist will not work anymore like it did for our parents and our grandparents.

I think.

[Speaker 2] (1:40:00 - 1:40:01)

It's almost guaranteed not to work. Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:40:02 - 1:40:07)

I think a really good advice is whatever your grandparents tell you, do the opposite.

[Speaker 2] (1:40:10 - 1:40:11)

Interestingly, interestingly.

[Speaker 4] (1:40:12 - 1:40:12)

I guess.

[Speaker 2] (1:40:13 - 1:40:25)

I somewhat disagree. Like to be honest with you, if I was, like I would actually, like most people ask me, okay, you know, you guys dropped out of college. Should we drop out of college?

I said, no, don't drop out of college. Like stay in college.

[Speaker 5] (1:40:25 - 1:40:25)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:40:25 - 1:40:38)

Right. Like, and see, the problems that you're bringing up are absolutely 100% true. I think the answer to that is just reform.

Like there is a way to just build a better education system that adds value.

[Speaker 1] (1:40:38 - 1:41:09)

But I'll tell you, I agreed with you up until a few years ago. I'm going to get so much crap for saying this, but the quality of free resources, the access to books for free. Yeah.

The access to quality education for free is going up at such a pace that to not have the conformity that is required to be in an institution, which is built on legacy, like a college. I don't know if today the pros and cons kind of like weigh each other out.

[Speaker 2] (1:41:09 - 1:41:18)

There were always more pros 10 years ago. So if you had, let's say, a nephew, right? Or let's say even like, like just like an average.

[Speaker 1] (1:41:18 - 1:41:18)

I have a nephew.

[Speaker 2] (1:41:19 - 1:41:21)

Okay. He has a nephew. But like I will say this, let's take an average.

[Speaker 1] (1:41:21 - 1:41:29)

His school doesn't have exams. I find it so weird. That's awesome, right?

His school doesn't have exams till 10th standard. They teach them how to like grind spices and stuff like that.

[Speaker 2] (1:41:29 - 1:41:30)

Wow, that's amazing.

[Speaker 1] (1:41:31 - 1:41:34)

Where did you go to school? It's a Jiddu Krishnamoorthi school. Wow.

[Speaker 2] (1:41:34 - 1:41:39)

Oh, you know, I almost went to Valley, Vrishnavalli. I almost went there when I was seven.

[Speaker 1] (1:41:39 - 1:42:00)

Yeah, but this guy is incredible. Okay. Like Jiddu never wrote a book, but he spoke a lot that people have kind of like collated and made books out of it.

But Jiddu believed that competition in itself, the fact that I want to compete with you to be better at something is defeat before the competition begins.

[Speaker 5] (1:42:00 - 1:42:00)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:42:01 - 1:42:08)

I need to find my peace inside of myself. And he believed the real winners of society are people

like Buddha.

[Speaker 2] (1:42:09 - 1:42:10)

That's very anti-capitalist.

[Speaker 1] (1:42:10 - 1:42:11)

It is.

[Speaker 2] (1:42:11 - 1:42:11)

Very.

[Speaker 1] (1:42:11 - 1:42:23)

But that was a big Jiddu thing. But that's why he also said that he's not a preacher. That's why he didn't write books.

Because he said, the minute I become a preacher, if I am a guru, then a guru needs to have following.

[Speaker 2] (1:42:24 - 1:42:54)

So if you're, okay, so we're coming back to the point, like if you're someone in this age category that's getting out of high school or school, like your formal schooling education. Okay. Let's say I'm an ambitious, you know, smart, talented person from like a very humble background in like a tier three, tier four city.

I've just graduated from high school. What do I do? Like I'm, I want to, I have no clear goal building a good life for myself and my future family, etc.

[Speaker 1] (1:42:55 - 1:43:05)

What would you do? I don't know about high school, but if you're in college, in college, you would figure out a skill set to learn. But would you recommend that person to go to college?

[Speaker 2] (1:43:05 - 1:43:07)

I think undergrad is what he's talking about.

[Speaker 1] (1:43:07 - 1:43:11)

Like, I think they could all voluntarily choose to go to college.

[Speaker 2] (1:43:11 - 1:43:14)

Would you ask, would you tell that person, okay, you should go to college or not?

[Speaker 1] (1:43:15 - 1:44:37)

Even if I might think otherwise, I will get chastised for saying it here. Let me not. I think innately people who seek knowledge only truly ever get knowledge.

I don't think you can push someone into a position where you can beat a hammer down his head and, you know, ingrain knowledge. I think school is important. I think interpersonal skills, learning how to work in a group, learning how to deal with people is extremely relevant.

Forget education, forget college, forget all of that. Say Tara is a plumber, say Aditya is a carpenter, I am a banker and Navya is something else. If we all had a kid in the society, one of us had a kid, if either of them had a kid, all of us would spend time with the kid and he would look at each of us for the skills that he's interested in and learn from that.

That way the kid is not ingrained with, you know, mimetic beliefs of his parents. Why should my child want to do what I think is right for him to do? I think that room, that freedom, that democratic sense of picking what he wants will only be allowed, that inculcation will only happen in a society which is not conformist, which is not today.

But in a very utopian scenario, like if I had to paint it, I would paint a world like that.

[Speaker 2] (1:44:37 - 1:44:45)

Would you recommend that person to start a company or to go into a job? The average, like I'm talking about like tens of, if not hundreds of millions of people.

[Speaker 1] (1:44:45 - 1:45:31)

I think it doesn't matter. I think really, I think starting a company, getting a job, the salary one gets, all of that is tier two to his own mind and the evolution of his mind and how he's able to evolve. I think one follows the other.

I feel like if this person is able to absorb all that his mind is truly capable of, I don't think anybody needs to worry about how much money he's making. And money is one lens of viewing what we think is successful. I think it's the lens of today, but that's fair.

Content, like fulfillment, right? I don't think person A, if he has three times more money than person B, is necessarily the only qualifying parameter for success.

[Speaker 4] (1:45:31 - 1:45:55)

I think that has to change. I don't think that's a metric for success, but I'm saying for someone in high school or in college that would, especially if we're looking at tier two and three, that plays

into a very large factor of what their day-to-day life is. So it's easier to say, you know, start a business, but is that realistically something that they would opt to do?

[Speaker 2] (1:45:55 - 1:46:06)

Yeah, of course, of course. But like, okay, if you guys could change to this point on Gen Z and next generation, if you guys could change something about education, right? Like, what would you change?

[Speaker 3] (1:46:06 - 1:49:17)

Gosh, you know, I grew up, and I still do, and I will always have learning disabilities. Do you mind elaborating? So I have learning disabilities.

A lot of people get very confused by this term. I grew up being bullied for it, actually. It was a primary cause for why people used to harass me in school and in college, more in college, actually, which is very funny observation to have had.

So it could be dyslexia, dysgraphia, dyscalculia. I have dyscalculia, which is an arithmetic disability. Many people have it.

They spend their whole lives not knowing that they have it. But my experience has been that everybody's learning capacity is different, which is why when you brought up how your nephew doesn't have exams till the 10th grade, that's fascinating to me and absolutely wonderful. If I ever have a child, I would want my child to learn that way, because we're inculcating the very thing that is polluting society and has polluted society for such a long time that I'm just like, if we're doing this from when a child is two years old, they're giving exams from when they're like three and four years old.

Why? Everyone's IQ, EQ is so different. Someone might take longer to learn something.

Someone might just never learn something that we're expected to learn at such a young age. And that's, I mean, that's been my personal experience. And I've noticed it with even my mom, for example.

She struggles with the same stuff that I struggled in school. But at that time, this conversation also of having learning disabilities, people call it all sorts of crazy things in schools and colleges, because we don't understand it because we don't talk about it. So if there's something in education I could change, it is the fact that it's like the Montessori system, right?

That's great. Why don't more children go on and why don't more parents inculcate that system with learning? There's so much more that we can do and change in our education system.

Soft skills, life skills, first aid, basic banking, understanding of how to communicate in groups

better. We're all going to work at some stage in life, whether that's as a homemaker. We're all part of interpersonal relationships throughout our lives.

And we're not taught that we're taught competition, especially as women. And I just don't understand these concepts. And this is something that begins in school.

And it, of course, does begin at home as well. But if we just understood how to adapt and how to change. God, I really hope I don't get into trouble for saying all of this.

But there are so many different ways to learn. And I feel like sometimes in the West, they've understood that. And I know that because I know a lot of educators in the West.

My sister is one of them. And it's just a very interesting way to learn. And kids grow up happier.

There's a lot less the rate of depression in kids today is. And mental health, the conversation that we can have on this will be for days. But I mean, it's very upsetting because we're not open to the change in how we can change education.

And it starts at two and three years old. It doesn't start by the time you're nine. Most of your habits are set.

So if we're starting this at two and three, I mean, that's really scary. And that's really sad. And having gone through this in my own experience, I just feel like there's much we can do to change.

[Speaker 2] (1:49:17 - 1:49:28)

Most of the people that are trying to tackle education are starting at like 10th grade and then whatever, you know, like undergrad, solving for entrance exams and all that. Whereas there's probably some very large opportunity.

[Speaker 1] (1:49:29 - 1:49:50)

But KV, the thing is, with the evolution of tech as quickly as it's happening, I think the upside of being able to regurgitate information that you have had to Memorize. Memorize by reading it a hundred times. I think the incremental value of that is dropping very quickly.

[Speaker 2] (1:49:50 - 1:50:56)

I 100% resonated everything that you said, right? Like viscerally. And I see it at scale.

The thing is, though, and I'm just using my own sort of life experiences and like that sort of ruthless competition. That like rigorous, unfair, extremely tough environment. Like I came from a very competitive school.

I love, I mean, I'm very grateful to my school. I came from a very competitive school and it was all

about who could, who would be the best, like academically, extracurricularly, from a sports perspective. Sort of, yeah.

In a way, but a lot less exciting and like a lot less attractive people. But in that world, right? Like I think the, you know, I don't think I would have even tried to do what I'm trying to do right now if it wasn't for that, like somewhat, and I agree with you, somewhat like semi-toxic, like aggressive line of sight.

[Speaker 3] (1:50:56 - 1:51:04)

But then doesn't that affect you for the rest of your life? Because if you grow up with that toxicity, which I think we all have, it's not, I'm not putting this on you, of course, or your school.

[Speaker 5] (1:51:04 - 1:51:06)

No, but I choose not to.

[Speaker 3] (1:51:08 - 1:51:16)

But don't you feel like you'll always have that, like in you, that sense of, I want to be better, I need to be the best, that sort of, which our generation struggles with so much.

[Speaker 2] (1:51:17 - 1:51:36)

Because the thing is like, if don't stop, if I wasn't doing what I was doing, I think I'd be unhappy. Like I was thinking about, and I joke with KV about this all the time, whenever we have a problem, I'm like, you should have just gone to Stanford. That would have made life so much easier.

Right? Actually, the pre-course of that is that I should have just got 95% in boards.

[Speaker 5] (1:51:36 - 1:51:39)

I should have just got the 95% and I got it sorted.

[Speaker 2] (1:51:39 - 1:52:04)

Yeah, that's the other part. If I was doing anything else, and maybe it could be because of the way that I grew up, I think I would have probably lost my mind. Because I, like, I'm, I really just get fulfilled.

And it's not like, like in my mind, I know like a lot of it is not, not nice, not, not, it's not wholesome, right? To be honest with you. No, it isn't.

But like, I really just get fulfilled and content by just like doing, like, awesome stuff.

[Speaker 3] (1:52:04 - 1:52:13)

But that's because of your bent of mind. And that's because of the person that you are. Now, sometimes people are not, but not, not everybody has that bent of mind.

Not everybody has that.

[Speaker 2] (1:52:13 - 1:52:21)

But if somebody has that bent of mind, and you put them in a school bed that doesn't cater it, do you lose that spark? Because, I mean, like, not me, like, there's a long way for us to go.

[Speaker 3] (1:52:21 - 1:52:21)

I get your point.

[Speaker 2] (1:52:21 - 1:52:25)

But like, that person could be the value creator for a hundred people.

[Speaker 3] (1:52:25 - 1:52:33)

I fully understand and agree with what you're saying. I just feel like if, I just, it's gonna sound crazy, but I feel like if you're born that way, if you would just have that.

[Speaker 2] (1:52:33 - 1:52:37)

But how do you know about it? How do you know that this is, this is the kid that is crazy? This is the kid that is not crazy?

[Speaker 3] (1:52:37 - 1:52:41)

They may not know, but the kid knows. I just always feel like, you just know, man.

[Speaker 2] (1:52:41 - 1:52:43)

Did you know? Did you know? Did I know?

[Speaker 3] (1:52:43 - 1:52:44)

He knew.

[Speaker 2] (1:52:45 - 1:52:49)

Did you know? I knew when I was like 13. 13, 14?

Even before the boat?

[Speaker 3] (1:52:50 - 1:52:50)

Before.

[Speaker 2] (1:52:50 - 1:52:52)

Yeah, 13, 14, I knew I had, I had, like, something wrong with.

[Speaker 1] (1:52:54 - 1:52:55)

What is wrong with? I knew it too, but what?

[Speaker 2] (1:52:56 - 1:53:02)

You knew when you were 13? When you're 13, like, you just get a sense something is not clicking.

[Speaker 5] (1:53:03 - 1:53:03)

What is not wrong?

[Speaker 2] (1:53:05 - 1:53:15)

No, I mean, it's just like. Go on. Tell us, Adit, what is really wrong with you?

No, I mean, like, what Tara is saying, right? No, no, not what Tara.

[Speaker 1] (1:53:16 - 1:53:19)

What is wrong with you? Deep down.

[Speaker 2] (1:53:20 - 1:53:28)

I can't get fulfilled or content with just, like, the wholesome, nicer things in life. That's what's wrong with me. Like, I'm.

[Speaker 3] (1:53:28 - 1:53:32)

Lots of people have that. What is your definition of wholesome?

[Speaker 2] (1:53:33 - 1:53:48)

Like, build a nice family. You know, do reasonably well for yourself. Take care of, like, all the basic comforts of life.

And then just focus on, like, enjoying your life. And the thing is. Did you have a good childhood?

I mean, yeah, that's a wow.

[Speaker 1] (1:53:49 - 1:53:49)

Like, yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:53:50 - 1:53:52)

It's a googly, huh? It's like, what's the right answer?

[Speaker 1] (1:53:52 - 1:54:14)

It's a googly, like, it was not easy. Can I tell you, we're all such a factor of our childhoods? Yeah, yeah, you're right.

100%. This is something I've had all my life. I've not had a sense of self-worth.

And nothing makes me happy beyond a fleeting minute. Really? It's hot for a minute.

And then I need something else to chase, something new to do, something I don't want to do.

[Speaker 2] (1:54:15 - 1:54:17)

You don't have that, like, long-term fulfillment after everything that you've built?

[Speaker 1] (1:54:18 - 1:54:40)

Really? I don't. And I'm 10 years down the journey.

And I can tell you this, that it won't come from anything you do outside or any other person. But from you going back to your childhood, figuring out, deep, deep down, the truth is, it was not your fault. Yeah.

But I'll connect you to someone who really helped. I'll tell you the thing with therapists.

[Speaker 2] (1:54:41 - 1:54:42)

Nikhil, I think you could be a therapist.

[Speaker 1] (1:54:44 - 1:54:53)

I'll tell you, I've been to a few. And the problem with therapy is 9 out of 10 are horrible. Like, they're terrible.

They suck, I know. But you need to find that one.

[Speaker 2] (1:54:54 - 1:54:57)

Do you think they're terrible by design or just because it's more than one?

[Speaker 4] (1:54:57 - 1:54:59)

You just have to find your product market fit.

[Speaker 2] (1:54:59 - 1:55:06)

You know, it's not always gonna work. Do you think certain therapists work for certain people? Or they're just good therapists and bad therapists?

[Speaker 1] (1:55:06 - 1:55:09)

They're good therapists and they're bad. Like, there is good everything and good bad everything. Interesting.

[Speaker 2] (1:55:10 - 1:55:18)

But it's interesting. Like, it's like, a lot of the problems that you might have had in your childhood could have been solved. Like, everything could be sorted now.

But now it's like, ****.

[Speaker 3] (1:55:18 - 1:55:19)

It's there in you, yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:55:19 - 1:56:06)

Yeah, it's in green. It's all in there. So, I spent one year, like, whenever you dream, right?

When you have vivid dreams, you only remember them for the first 10 minutes that you're awake. So, I did this like a habit. I was reading some school of psychology.

So, I would wake up every morning and write down my dreams in the first five minutes. Even if I woke up at 4am, I would write it down. The crazy thing is, even in your dreams, there is a pattern.

Documentation is the key. What a therapist is doing for you, essentially, is documenting your thoughts. Your ups and your downs.

It's like how you make decisions based on data, right? You don't have data around your thoughts. Having an external resource allows you to formalize that data in a manner where you can infer something.

[Speaker 2] (1:56:06 - 1:56:12)

And KV and I do this, right? Sundays, I just sit in the office and I'm surrounded by whiteboards and that's it. Like, I have nothing to do.

[Speaker 4] (1:56:12 - 1:56:28)

Yeah, I do that. I'm a pen and paper kind of person. I plan.

I mean, not personally, but I'll plan, like, where do I want to, like, what do I want to do? Like, how do I get there? Like, I make charts with arrows and things like that.

Like, that's how I figure it out in my head. I have to put it down somewhere.

[Speaker 1] (1:56:29 - 1:56:32)

Yeah, yeah. I've been writing a book for a long time, which I will never publish. Aww.

[Speaker 2] (1:56:33 - 1:56:36)

But the beauty of it. Just for my benefit.

[Speaker 1] (1:56:36 - 1:56:56)

Okay, I'll publish it. But it's so vulnerable in that, that, you know, it also helps me kind of reflect upon myself. So it's for me.

It's a book from me for me. Okay, I have a question for you, which is a good digress from here. 65% of startups shut down because the founders fight.

[Speaker 4] (1:56:56 - 1:56:56)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:56:57 - 1:56:58)

Egos.

[Speaker 4] (1:56:58 - 1:57:01)

Okay. But they're the Zepto brothers.

[Speaker 5] (1:57:01 - 1:57:01)

Come on, brothers.

[Speaker 1] (1:57:03 - 1:57:19)

Grocery. Egos. Grocery, man.

Egos. Okay, this is important to a lot of people who are starting companies in their 20s. How do you stop yourself from getting egoistic?

One will be more popular than the other.

[Speaker 5] (1:57:19 - 1:57:19)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:57:20 - 1:57:48)

At different times, it'll change. One probably will at some point by virtue of outside influences, own more of the company than the other, be perceived in the company in its own little bubble of hierarchy in a different order than was the preconceived notion in different people's minds. How do you deal with all this?

Can I ask you that question? Yeah, sure. With Nitin, right?

Yeah. How did you do that? So we have the added advantage of being brothers.

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:57:49 - 1:57:53)

Yeah, we're brothers, man. Same thing. Same thing.

[Speaker 1] (1:57:53 - 1:58:37)

So we do completely different things. Yeah. So all my time is spent on stock market related stuff.

All his time is spent on people and broking related stuff. So we don't get in each other. Broking related stuff.

So we don't get into each other's way. Like I do my piece and he does his piece and we just happen to complement each other. But that works for us.

But that being said, you know, there are times when egos come into play. There are times when misunderstandings happen. Luckily for us, things that really helped is from the very beginning, we had everything on paper.

[Speaker 2] (1:58:37 - 1:58:37)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:58:37 - 1:59:41)

Oh, really? And we were very much- Without formal, like as brothers. See, this is an old journey, right?

Like when I started trading full time, I was 17. When we started working together full time, we started a company called Karmath Associates. Which is what, 16 years ago now?

And we've been on this journey for so long. Along the way, we've had lawyers, we've had constitutions, we've had many ups and downs. But the one thing we've never had is anyone outside.

We've not had investors. We've not had debt. We've run it like an old school shop, like an old school banya business in the farce of a modern company.

That helped. But still, there will be misunderstandings and neither of us generally agree. Whenever there is a misunderstanding.

But if it is my part of business, if it's anything to do with stock markets, investing, trading, related stuff, I take the final call. If it's his part of the business, anything related to product, people, broking, all of that, he takes the call.

[Speaker 2] (1:59:42 - 1:59:53)

Makes sense. Yeah. Look, I mean, I think with KV and I, it's similar.

I think it just comes from like deep respect. Like I truly in my bones believe that KV is much more talented and intelligent than I am.

[Speaker 1] (1:59:53 - 2:00:03)

Do you also voice it as many times because you fear this altercation might happen based on numbers, 65%? Yeah. Look, I think you're right.

[Speaker 2] (2:00:03 - 2:00:46)

I used to, but today I believe it. Like today I tell KV that he's smarter than I am because he probably is. Right.

And I think the, I know that there's the chance of us getting here. We were like 18, 24 months ago sitting in a table in his living room. I was sitting here.

With Nikhil Kamath and doing all this stuff. Don't make me sound like that. Yeah.

No, but, but I'm like, like I know for a fact viscerally after going through it, I couldn't have gone through it without KV. I couldn't have done it. I wanted to quit in the early days when we were failing.

So we were failing.

[Speaker 1] (2:00:47 - 2:00:50)

Your boyfriend was been failing you so much. You missed all of it.

[Speaker 2] (2:00:50 - 2:00:55)

I was just praising him. He was doing the good stuff, man. He said you were smarter than him.

All of that is, all of that is like.

[Speaker 1] (2:00:55 - 2:00:58)

Have there been nights where you have cuddled and gone to bed together?

[Speaker 2] (2:01:01 - 2:01:06)

So you know what? At the end, one of you guys just make a montage of all the weird questions.

[Speaker 5] (2:01:06 - 2:01:06)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (2:01:10 - 2:01:20)

It would get weird if I asked them that question. Is this the only podcast where the innuendos come in? I don't think you asked Rajat these questions.

He asked them, they just cut it out.

[Speaker 4] (2:01:21 - 2:01:22)

Whatever.

[Speaker 2] (2:01:23 - 2:01:24)

Yeah. I'm going to ask everybody.

[Speaker 4] (2:01:25 - 2:01:26)

If they cuddle together?

[Speaker 1] (2:01:30 - 2:02:27)

I mean, I think it's just like. I think it's healthy. Like endorphins get released and shit.

Everybody should cuddle a bit more in life. Can I give you guys some advice as an older brother? Yeah.

Like when things happen so abruptly in life, often we don't realize that our actions of yesterday, which used to be funny, today can be misconstrued to be something else altogether. Because you've only been doing this for X amount of time. But everything has changed.

Like a king's son is prepared to be the king all his life. But for people who are starting off first gen, you might not take your actions so seriously. But society will not be so forgiving as.

But let me make another point.

[Speaker 2] (2:02:27 - 2:02:40)

And I actually want to know, like for all four of us here, like what would your advice be? Like all of us are doing, trying to do something else. Like what, from your vantage point, as like the elder statesman.

The future prime minister of this country.

[Speaker 1] (2:02:41 - 2:02:43)

Professional advice? Personal advice? Both.

[Speaker 2] (2:02:44 - 2:02:49)

I don't ask Nikhil personal advice. Oh wow. Dude, they got it.

[Speaker 4] (2:02:50 - 2:02:51)

You can give us both.

[Speaker 2] (2:02:51 - 2:02:52)

Continue, sorry.

[Speaker 1] (2:02:54 - 2:03:37)

Professional advice would be what I just said. And I'm saying that more so because I've experienced it. Keep that one group of friends who you are, you know, yourself with.

But the lesser said, so much better than more being said outside of that. And I've learned it the hard way. And I feel like, I feel like you should eliminate drama in your life.

This is personal advice. So what I do as an exercise is, take all the people in your life, whoever is adding drama, write their name down and just eliminate them from your life. Because situations are often dramatic, but more often than not, people are dramatic and they draw that into your life.

[Speaker 2] (2:03:38 - 2:03:40)

She resonates with that. You resonate with that? She resonates with that.

[Speaker 4] (2:03:41 - 2:03:42)

I think we all do at some level.

[Speaker 1] (2:03:43 - 2:03:45)

Personally that, professionally that.

[Speaker 2] (2:03:45 - 2:03:46)

Okay.

[Speaker 1] (2:03:49 - 2:03:57)

What's happening with Bollywood amongst Gen Z? Is the interest in Bollywood going down compared to 10 years ago?

[Speaker 3] (2:03:57 - 2:04:01)

I don't think the interest in the industry is going down. I think.

[Speaker 5] (2:04:08 - 2:04:09)

Oh my God.

[Speaker 4] (2:04:09 - 2:04:14)

Oh my God. She's so fun like this. I love it.

[Speaker 2] (2:04:16 - 2:04:23)

So on the way here, we're trying to figure out what you're thinking. What's the next generation thinking? Yeah.

[Speaker 4] (2:04:24 - 2:04:27)

Nice one. Yeah, that's a good one. To the point.

I like it.

[Speaker 1] (2:04:27 - 2:04:27)

Yeah.

[Speaker 4] (2:04:28 - 2:04:29)

We ourselves don't know what we're thinking.

[Speaker 1] (2:04:30 - 2:04:30)

Yeah.

[Speaker 4] (2:04:31 - 2:04:32)

That's honestly the reality.

[Speaker 1] (2:04:33 - 2:04:34)

Tara, what's happening is...

[Speaker 3] (2:04:37 - 2:04:41)

Try to keep a straight face. Yes, Nikhil.

[Speaker 1] (2:04:42 - 2:04:44)

So Tara, what do you think about...

[Speaker 2] (2:04:47 - 2:04:49)

This is the second time I've heard Nikhil ask this question.

[Speaker 5] (2:04:49 - 2:04:50)

This is so bad.

[Speaker 2] (2:04:52 - 2:04:53)

Oh man.

[Speaker 5] (2:04:54 - 2:04:55)

So bad.

[Speaker 2] (2:04:55 - 2:04:56)

It is a no-brainer.

[Speaker 5] (2:05:00 - 2:05:05)

Okay, first question. Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (2:05:05 - 2:05:09)

I'll come to... That's in the tape. Okay.

Okay.

[Speaker 3] (2:05:16 - 2:05:22)

I'm just going to look somewhere else.

[Speaker 5] (2:05:23 - 2:05:26)

We spoke somehow. He's laughing.

[Speaker 3] (2:05:26 - 2:05:32)

He's laughing now. I'm just going to cheat the look. I can still see you smiling.

[Speaker 2] (2:05:32 - 2:05:33)

Look at his nose.

[Speaker 3] (2:05:34 - 2:05:38)

I'm cheating with his ear. I'm literally looking at Nikhil's ear. I'm pretending I'm looking at him.

[Speaker 4] (2:05:38 - 2:05:40)

Look at your camera. Just look at your camera. It's fine.

[Speaker 1] (2:05:40 - 2:05:43)

Does it look like I'm crying? I can ask an emotional question.

[Speaker 3] (2:05:46 - 2:05:47)

Tara, are you okay?

[Speaker 5] (2:05:48 - 2:05:49)

I'm absolutely fine.

[Speaker 1] (2:05:49 - 2:05:51)

I'm having an intense emotional discussion. Okay, Tara.

[Speaker 5] (2:05:51 - 2:05:52)

Oh my god.

[Speaker 1] (2:05:52 - 2:05:54)

You're going to snap out of it. Yeah.

[Speaker 3] (2:05:57 - 2:06:01)

Okay, okay. Got it, got it.

[Speaker 1] (2:06:03 - 2:06:06)

It's a happy vodcast. I'm back, I'm back.

[Speaker 3] (2:06:07 - 2:06:09)

Very late. Okay. So late.

Yes.

[Speaker 1] (2:06:10 - 2:06:25)

As someone in this age bracket. We're ready. One, two, three, go.

As a young person. As a young star.

[Speaker 3] (2:06:25 - 2:06:27)

Can I just like hide under the table right now?

[Speaker 4] (2:06:28 - 2:06:38)

I'm going to start with my answer. What is Bollywood thinking? What is Gen Z thinking about Bollywood?

[Speaker 3] (2:06:38 - 2:07:45)

Honestly, I feel like as a generation, we're craving the kind of films that we grew up loving and watching. I feel like recently, and I've had this conversation with a bunch of people in and outside of the industry, we're not making the kind of films that we grew up loving and watching. Whether that's rom-coms, whether that's, you know, situational comedies, whether that's certain genres.

It's just fun, lighter films. I feel like while it's amazing that we've gotten into making more serious cinema and cinema that's so meaningful, which is so important, obviously, especially in a, you know, towards a generation that is a thinking generation and that cares about things that have meaning and depth. And that's why films like Rocky or Rani and so many of the films that have been doing well recently, that are lighter, more fun films.

These are things that we're craving. We've also seen a very horrible time in every way recently. Every family has had, you know, almost every family has had a loss.

There's been a huge tragedy with COVID. Economically, we've just, you know, been in this slump. So I feel like we just want to go back to the movies and Gen Z is, we're at that exciting stage where we want to look at happier content.

[Speaker 1] (2:07:45 - 2:08:01)

You know, there is this distinction. A lot of really young people are trying to become influencers. Do you think influencers are a threat to Bollywood actors?

And is that line blurring? And if you had a piece of advice for everybody who wants to be an influencer, what would it be?

[Speaker 3] (2:08:02 - 2:08:05)

So, because I'm not really in the space, I'm not really sure what advice I could give.

[Speaker 2] (2:08:05 - 2:08:07)

Do you think of yourself as an influencer? Sorry, before you answer those questions.

[Speaker 3] (2:08:08 - 2:08:31)

I don't. So the stuff that I put out on social media isn't stuff that, and I'm fully aware of this and I have accepted it. And I still choose to put out certain things on social media that I know necessarily may not resonate with a lot of people.

But that's me. And that's organically, just the stuff that I post pretty often. Which is?

Food related stuff that is not necessarily the kind of stuff that you would imagine.

[Speaker 5] (2:08:32 - 2:08:32)

Or literature.

[Speaker 3] (2:08:33 - 2:08:58)

Or just the songs that I listen to. Nobody is listening to that. Almost nobody is listening to it.

No one really connects to it. No one probably likes it. The random stuff that I post.

So I'm not sure about what advice I would give them. But I just feel like, I don't think, to answer your first question, I don't think that they would necessarily be threatening to my line of work. I feel like there's separate things to watch.

[Speaker 1] (2:08:58 - 2:09:12)

How easy is it to monetize? Let's say you have 9 million followers on Instagram. If you had to live and earn a wage just based on that, is it highly rewarding from a financial lens?

[Speaker 3] (2:09:13 - 2:09:47)

I would imagine so. I wouldn't know because that's not what I do. But I would imagine so.

It's not something I personally connect with and think that I could do. But it definitely takes a lot. A lot of energy.

A lot of time. A lot of thinking. What makes me confused is when I see stuff that seems a little bit pointless and a little bit daft sometimes.

I just wonder why we're giving into content sometimes that just isn't fulfilling anything.

[Speaker 1] (2:09:47 - 2:09:52)

Do you think influencers have a responsibility of what they are promoting and selling?

[Speaker 3] (2:09:53 - 2:10:09)

As much as all of us do when we post. Because we're all influencing someone, right? Whether that's me with however many followers.

Whether that's a friend of mine who has 300 followers. Whether that's whoever. We all have that responsibility.

But at the same time, I believe in not taking things so seriously.

[Speaker 1] (2:10:09 - 2:10:17)

What is selling right now? Say I'm 20 and I want to be an influencer. What should I do to build distribution?

Should we even encourage it?

[Speaker 3] (2:10:17 - 2:10:19)

What, a 20-year-old who's an influencer?

[Speaker 1] (2:10:20 - 2:10:28)

Who wants to be an influencer. I don't see a particular reason to dissuade anyone from wanting to be an influencer.

[Speaker 3] (2:10:28 - 2:10:30)

Or doing anything that they want to do.

[Speaker 1] (2:10:31 - 2:10:41)

Increasingly, our worlds are actually becoming virtual, right? And if you were to live in the virtual world, this is a commodity that you can expend in exchange for a resource.

[Speaker 2] (2:10:41 - 2:11:17)

The slight problem that I have is that the influencer has become sexy. It's become a sexy thing to do if you're young. Like, to try to pursue.

And you have people pursuing it for the wrong reasons, right? What is the right reason to pursue being an influencer? You know, Tara, I'm just giving basis to what I just learned over this conversation.

Like, you for example, you have a deep love for the arts. You are not. You are not.

But Tara is very different to an influencer. I know, I know. But I'm just...

I'm like, I'm just thinking about principally. Like, you know, like someone like a... Like a...

Okay, like for example, an influencer. Like a financial influencer.

[Speaker 5] (2:11:17 - 2:11:17)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (2:11:18 - 2:11:33)

Like, you know, they're... You know some of these guys. Yeah, they're doing it like...

The good ones are doing it just like out of a genuine passion for like educating people about basic financial principles that can help them improve their lives. No, I... That's...

I think so.

[Speaker 3] (2:11:33 - 2:11:34)

Actually, I mean, yeah.

[Speaker 2] (2:11:35 - 2:11:47)

Most... Like, you know, like the... I mean, like maybe principally.

Maybe it doesn't happen in practice. But like the influencers... In practice, it's always like good-looking guys and girls that are just like get distribution for the reason that they're good-looking.

And then they sell...

[Speaker 4] (2:11:47 - 2:12:35)

What are your thoughts on this? Goes back to my point of that we are going to consume influencers. We're going to consume different kinds of content.

It's up to us as individuals of what we resonate with. What we choose to believe in. What we choose to practice.

And what we choose to take forward in our lives. I mean, you open Instagram, you'll find influencers. At the same time, you'll find a lot of great content.

You'll find a lot of great people who are putting out good stuff. And some influencers who are actually... Yeah, who are doing genuine things.

But like I said earlier as well, it's like you can't sit and complain, blame the platform and the people. You have to then figure out, you know, yourself as an... The audience.

Yeah, and like what exactly you are consuming. I mean, I'm that person. I will always hold myself accountable to things.

I will not complain and blame.

[Speaker 2] (2:12:35 - 2:12:36)

It's the audience only.

[Speaker 4] (2:12:36 - 2:12:36)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (2:12:37 - 2:12:41)

I think the audience like diverges towards lust more than anything else.

[Speaker 4] (2:12:41 - 2:12:46)

Yeah, but I mean, that's a normal biological human trait. Like you have to...

[Speaker 2] (2:12:46 - 2:12:48)

Kiwi's coming in from the point of view of a 21 year old.

[Speaker 4] (2:12:48 - 2:12:52)

No, but he's coming from a fair point of view. He's coming from a fair point of view.

[Speaker 2] (2:12:52 - 2:12:52)

21 to 30.

[Speaker 4] (2:12:53 - 2:13:03)

No, but any Gen Z is looking at love, relationships and heartbreak. I think those are like the top three things that they're probably consuming or watching. Whether it's on television, whether it's on Instagram.

[Speaker 1] (2:13:03 - 2:13:09)

I'll ask each one of you specifically. Are you going to get married and have kids or not? Adit?

I'm very excited to have kids.

[Speaker 4] (2:13:09 - 2:13:09)

Yeah?

[Speaker 1] (2:13:10 - 2:13:11)

Yeah. With marriage.

[Speaker 4] (2:13:11 - 2:13:14)

I will definitely get married. And we'll definitely have kids.

[Speaker 1] (2:13:14 - 2:13:14)

By what age?

[Speaker 4] (2:13:16 - 2:13:19)

That I don't know. But I'll definitely get married and then we'll have kids.

[Speaker 2] (2:13:20 - 2:13:21)

30 to 35-ish. Tara?

[Speaker 3] (2:13:22 - 2:13:24)

At some stage, I'd love to be married. Sure.

[Speaker 2] (2:13:24 - 2:13:26)

What I'm most excited about is having kids.

[Speaker 3] (2:13:26 - 2:13:27)

That's so sweet.

[Speaker 2] (2:13:27 - 2:13:29)

Same. Not now, in 10 years, but eventually.

[Speaker 3] (2:13:30 - 2:13:31)

That's sweet.

[Speaker 2] (2:13:32 - 2:13:34)

Kids. Why do you guys all want to have kids?

[Speaker 3] (2:13:36 - 2:13:37)

The thought of that.

[Speaker 2] (2:13:38 - 2:13:42)

Why? You guys are 21 years old. Okay, we are?

[Speaker 4] (2:13:43 - 2:13:45)

He was probably too young to ask this question.

[Speaker 2] (2:13:45 - 2:13:47)

Yeah, you guys are kids. What are you talking about having kids?

[Speaker 4] (2:13:47 - 2:13:48)

Yeah, y'all are like pups.

[Speaker 2] (2:13:48 - 2:13:50)

I'm younger than him. I'm very excited to have kids.

[Speaker 4] (2:13:50 - 2:13:53)

No, I'm definitely getting married.

[Speaker 2] (2:13:53 - 2:13:55)

Nikhil, Nikhil, one second. Why is no one asking Nikhil? Nikhil, do you want to have kids?

No.

[Speaker 4] (2:13:56 - 2:13:57)

I know he doesn't want to have kids.

[Speaker 1] (2:13:58 - 2:14:12)

I don't believe in marriage. I don't believe in kids. What does that mean?

What do you mean you don't believe in marriage? I feel like being alone, we think it is a bad thing. Because society has convinced us that being alone is a bad thing.

You don't think it's a bad thing? No. I don't think so.

[Speaker 2] (2:14:13 - 2:14:14)

I think alone is not a bad thing.

[Speaker 1] (2:14:14 - 2:14:15)

Wait, wait, wait.

[Speaker 2] (2:14:15 - 2:14:27)

We're family. Is there a missing value that's on the table? That you're not able to tap into if you're alone.

Versus having like a long term, like 50 year long relationship. I think the opposite is true.

[Speaker 1] (2:14:28 - 2:14:43)

Your ability to evolve is probably highest in isolation. If you're around people, you're going to be biased by virtue of your surroundings. If you want to truly evolve, you need objectivity.

[Speaker 2] (2:14:43 - 2:14:58)

No, but like the thing is though Nikhil, sometimes I get the sense from you that like evolution is not the end. Like are you still like in a position where you're just constantly trying to improve? I don't, like why would you?

I don't know if you're in that state of mind right now. I don't know if I would be if I were you.

[Speaker 4] (2:14:59 - 2:15:15)

I mean, I don't agree with the fact that being alone is a form of evolution. I mean, historically, if you look at evolution, it's not that it's never been possible by just being alone. The whole concept of evolution is that you produce and that you...

[Speaker 2] (2:15:15 - 2:15:20)

No, no, I'm assuming that it is. He's like interpersonal, like his own evolution. That's procreation.

[Speaker 1] (2:15:20 - 2:15:21)

Evolution, I think is more...

[Speaker 2] (2:15:21 - 2:15:22)

Yeah, but still procreation.

[Speaker 4] (2:15:22 - 2:15:29)

As beings, to having evolved from cavemen to what we are today, was only possible because of procreation.

[Speaker 2] (2:15:29 - 2:15:29)

Also time.

[Speaker 4] (2:15:30 - 2:15:32)

Yeah, time, but also because of procreation.

[Speaker 2] (2:15:32 - 2:15:47)

But Nikhil's not looking for evolution when he's dead. He wants evolution today. We'll create life and build that.

No, but like do you really want evolution today? Like, I'm sure you're much more hedonistic than you were a decade ago. Less so.

Really? Less so. Seriously?

[Speaker 1] (2:15:48 - 2:15:55)

I would have thought this podcast was hedonistic in nature. It's vain in nature. I don't know about hedonistic.

[Speaker 2] (2:15:55 - 2:15:57)

No, vain is like a vanity.

[Speaker 1] (2:15:57 - 2:16:13)

Like serving vanity is a form of hedonism. It's self-serving that I get to learn about interesting things with interesting people at my convenience. That is vain.

That is vanity that I have to be cognizant of. Hedonistic, I don't know. I wouldn't appreciate that.

[Speaker 2] (2:16:13 - 2:16:15)

Really? Are you not in that phase of life where you're just trying to enjoy yourself?

[Speaker 1] (2:16:15 - 2:16:24)

No. Really? No.

Seriously? This is what I'm telling you. That never changes.

The more you **** something which is coming from outside.

[Speaker 5] (2:16:24 - 2:16:24)

That's what I was going to say.

[Speaker 1] (2:16:25 - 2:16:26)

You give me hope, dude.

[Speaker 5] (2:16:26 - 2:16:28)

I was like, no, ****. Oh, ****.

[Speaker 1] (2:16:28 - 2:16:30)

See, all these things that you're thinking, importance.

[Speaker 4] (2:16:30 - 2:16:32)

Others having an existential crisis.

[Speaker 1] (2:16:32 - 2:16:35)

Money, all of that. Oh, no. Anything that comes from outside.

[Speaker 2] (2:16:35 - 2:16:38)

No happiness, dude. Money doesn't buy happiness. That's what makes it sad.

[Speaker 1] (2:16:39 - 2:16:58)

That is true. The lack of money brings sorrow. Exponentially more money brings you slightly more insecurity.

And the semblance of power which is so intoxicating that you start to value things you should not value in a certain way in life more importantly than you should.

[Speaker 2] (2:16:58 - 2:17:07)

No, but I think in our world, value creation is so tangible. You can see people get employed. You can see people make a livelihood that would not have made it.

I think it's all perspective. I know.

[Speaker 1] (2:17:07 - 2:17:49)

But when I walk around a store. I'll tell you, I can think I employ X number of people. I can also think because I do something more efficiently, I eliminated 10X the number of people to employ these 1X people who work for me.

I agree. I know. I get what you're saying.

It's all perspective and the lens with which you're viewing it. It's an industry. Guys, just to bring it back to the topic, I'm going to do a bunch of like questions which we need to cover and we'll do it very quickly.

I'm going to ask each one of you. Tara, what do you think of woke culture? Everybody's fighting for rights, but very few people are equating how much they're contributing to the rights they deserve.

[Speaker 3] (2:17:50 - 2:17:55)

I think it's high time that we fight for certain rights that we haven't been able to fight for for a very long time.

[Speaker 1] (2:17:55 - 2:17:56)

For example?

[Speaker 3] (2:17:56 - 2:18:48)

Just equality based rights, whether that's when it comes to the difference between what men and women get paid in every sector, whether that's difference in how we're treated equality wise, whether that's gender biases that we've had for so long, whether that is anything and everything

that we're really standing up for. I think it's really important that we do have a voice and that we aren't afraid to talk about it. I've been trying to do that in a bunch of interviews recently where I feel like we haven't really touched upon so many topics, whether that's in the industry or outside or even just as a young woman.

So I think it's very important. But of course, when things like that are misused and spoken frivolously, that doesn't make sense to me. But I do think I'm an advocate of just rights for anybody that feels they have been treated inequally.

[Speaker 1] (2:18:49 - 2:19:01)

Makes sense. Navya, a lot of people say Gen Z is entitled and not very loyal. They prefer gig work.

What are your opinions on that?

[Speaker 4] (2:19:02 - 2:19:05)

I'm optimistic, so I don't believe that. I think that...

[Speaker 1] (2:19:05 - 2:19:06)

Do you experience it though?

[Speaker 4] (2:19:07 - 2:19:07)

No, I think...

[Speaker 1] (2:19:07 - 2:19:09)

Because you employ a lot of people as well.

[Speaker 4] (2:19:09 - 2:21:28)

I do. But like I said earlier, I think there's a lot of potential and not enough opportunities. And I understand why.

We have a very large population. I don't see why it's easy to give everybody an opportunity. But I think that there is a lot of potential, at least from what I've seen.

I employ a lot of young people. I work with a lot of young people and I speak to a lot of young people. And I think that they're not given a chance.

They're not given an opportunity. And if they were given one, I think that we'd be able to have a much larger conversation on this. I also think that when it comes to entitlement, I think that at least for Gen Z, we've inherited a world where there are a lot of issues, right?

Whether it's with social issues, economical or even political, I think that there are a lot of issues. And we're not given enough seats on the table to give our opinions on those issues. We do feed a certain limit of entitlement because we think that we're not given a chance to voice what we want.

And if you're saying that 60% of our population is young people, then why are we not being given those seats at those tables, whether it's at companies or whether it's at a political forum or whether it's in entertainment or content? I think that enabling us to be a part of that conversation or being a part of that, building that future. So I think that that's why that sense of entitlement comes in.

And like he said, he said that young people aren't taken seriously. And I think that I see that a lot, even when I'm in the development sector. But even in the development sector, young people are looked at upon as just being opportunistic or just trying to do what, like you said, wokeism, or we're considered to be too woke.

What is wokeism? I don't know what it is. But I would say that we're tagged that, we're tagged as a generation that's being too woke.

But I think we're just trying to rectify a lot of what has been done. And we're trying to build a future for ourselves because realistically, we are the ones who are going to be living the next 30 to 40 years in India, considering we're 60% of the population. So I think that it's important for us to be a part of a lot of these conversations, which we're not.

And that's why that sense of entitlement comes in, because essentially, if we're building a future for ourselves, then why not be proud of that? And why not entitle ourselves to build that? Right.

[Speaker 1] (2:21:29 - 2:21:56)

Tara, Gen Z has grown up in an Insta, Facebook world. Do you think they portray a confidence that they truly don't have? Because they've read, heard, prepared about things which are catastrophic in nature, but they've never truly experienced them.

Do you think there's a difference between theoretical information and pragmatic education?

[Speaker 3] (2:21:56 - 2:23:21)

You know, I actually feel like as a generation, everything is being put out as presentation because of the Instagram culture, which I do love. But I also feel like that creates a lot of problems with the generation because, like I said, it's all about presentation. What we actually feel is honestly, more often than not, quite contradictory and dichotomous to how we depict it to be on social media, whether that's Instagram or Facebook or whatever it is.

And that, I think, is a really big struggle that we have been facing and will continue to face as long

as we give it this sort of impetus. Like Navya has been saying this whole time, it's our choice, the amount of time that we choose to spend on this. And I just feel like it's for a lot of young people that I know personally, I can only speak because I've had those personal experiences with people.

It's become catastrophic to deal with because unfortunately, the young people, the young minds that have been so used to social media being such a huge part of their days have moulded themselves to becoming versions that they create because that's acceptable. And they create these acceptable versions of themselves for social media. But actually, honestly, more often than not, we're all quite different to what we portray.

[Speaker 1] (2:23:21 - 2:23:23)

What advice would you give to someone like this?

[Speaker 3] (2:23:24 - 2:23:50)

Who you actually are and what you really stand for as a young person in today's culture and today's climate, that's what really matters. So stay true to that because all of this is going to, it's all transient. It's going to go.

What I create today is not going to matter 10 years from now unless it's something that stays true to who I am. And I feel like we think that this is going to last forever. And it isn't.

Unless it's organic and it has depth and meaning.

[Speaker 1] (2:23:51 - 2:24:13)

Good answer. When I was a kid, this is very specifically to you. I was a dumb kid, you know, like the kind of kid who keeps staring at a fan, keeps bumping into walls.

I speak Kannada. So my family called me Boregauda, which means like you have bumps on your head, right? Because you're always bumping into walls.

Why were you like this?

[Speaker 3] (2:24:14 - 2:24:38)

I actually wasn't. I was, I've always been very clumsy. But very recently, no one believes me when I say these things.

I'm really glad that you brought this up. We heard from your sister. Yes, I, yes, I'm aware.

I'm really clumsy. I walk into walls. I don't see things that I really should be seeing.

[Speaker 1] (2:24:38 - 2:24:39)

A bit like Aadit in KV Tonight.

[Speaker 3] (2:24:40 - 2:24:40)

Yes.

[Speaker 2] (2:24:41 - 2:24:46)

That's a good, that's a good one. More, more weirder. That's like, that's like Aadit.

[Speaker 3] (2:24:48 - 2:24:52)

Oh, gosh. Go on, go on. No, I mean, very recently.

[Speaker 1] (2:24:52 - 2:24:53)

It's just walls?

[Speaker 3] (2:24:53 - 2:25:44)

No, well, to be honest, so we have. People also? Yeah, so we have, we were doing this barbecue at home.

And I didn't, I was going to welcome a guest. And the barbecue was outside on the outdoor area that we have at home. And I was not aware of the fact that my terrace door, which is a glass humongous door, was shut.

And I ran to welcome this guest with great enthusiasm, as you do. And I didn't realize that there was the glass door between us. And I ran towards this person to embrace this friend.

Banged into the glass, fell backwards, almost broke my nose. Had to shoot a close-up scene, very emotional scene for my last film, actually. The next day, with this randomly swollen nose, I used it to my advantage so that I looked like I was, you know, really been crying for hours and hours, of course.

So yeah, I still bang into.

[Speaker 2] (2:25:45 - 2:25:45)

Damn it.

[Speaker 3] (2:25:46 - 2:25:48)

Yeah, it's a real skill, man.

[Speaker 1] (2:25:48 - 2:25:49)

It's a real skill. Yeah, I believe.

[Speaker 3] (2:25:50 - 2:25:51)

So yeah, still very clumsy.

[Speaker 1] (2:25:52 - 2:26:05)

To both of you, because you have experienced this. And you two will experience this. How do you deal best with trolling?

Cancel culture. What is cancel culture? And how do you both deal with it?

Because I'm guessing...

[Speaker 2] (2:26:05 - 2:26:06)

Do you answer this also after there?

[Speaker 1] (2:26:06 - 2:26:09)

I do. Sure.

[Speaker 4] (2:26:11 - 2:26:13)

You go first.

[Speaker 1] (2:26:13 - 2:26:29)

Like, have you two woken up one day and been like, the situation might have not been so big. But in our own heads, things that happen to us become so much bigger. Than they actually are.

They're not than they actually are. Then others perceive them to be.

[Speaker 3] (2:26:29 - 2:27:35)

I know exactly what you mean. In my experience, I have more often than not, and this is thanks to my support system, and that's like my mom and dad. They have almost always, in fact always, been amused and laughed at whatever has happened in the news or the media.

Especially in the beginning of my career. Now no one really talks about it or really cares about it. Because everyone who matters knows it's untrue, right?

No, never really been truly affected by it. I also have to say this, because it's kind of important for me to say it. I feel really lucky that even though I'm not someone that posts a lot about myself, I've tried to change that a little bit so that people get to know me a little bit better.

Because that was sort of lacking in a certain sense with the way that I portrayed myself. I just wasn't letting people in and I wasn't talking much about what I stand for and what I believe in. And that actually went against me.

So I started doing that. But to be very honest with you, I don't feel like I have truly been trolled yet.

[Speaker 1] (2:27:35 - 2:27:36)

Not yet?

[Speaker 3] (2:27:36 - 2:28:05)

I don't think so. And I am happy about this. But at the same time, I feel like it's because people see me for me.

And that's because I put myself out there the way that I see myself. And not the way that I would like to see myself or the way I would like for others to see me. But just been true to myself.

And that's why when you asked me for advice to other people, it really has worked for me. There's a lot of ways that you can be when you're in this industry. And it's very easy to be fake.

And lots of people are very good at doing that. But it doesn't work.

[Speaker 2] (2:28:05 - 2:28:06)

Anyone in particular?

[Speaker 3] (2:28:09 - 2:28:10)

We'll chat in the Lyft, man.

[Speaker 1] (2:28:12 - 2:28:17)

Let's take this offline. How do you deal with it? What is the best way to deal with it?

[Speaker 2] (2:28:17 - 2:28:19)

For anyone who is seriously cancelled or trolled?

[Speaker 4] (2:28:20 - 2:30:02)

I'm sure. I think that for me, firstly, a large part of it is that let's not be ignorant to the fact that a large reason why people are even watching what I'm doing is probably because of my family and where I come from. So that's a large part of it.

I think that the second reason is that I've chosen to do what I do, which is be public and do

something that's very public and for people. So I can't sit and complain when people disagree to something that I do. I'm also a very practical person.

I think that especially in the field of work that I'm in, which is development sector, I think that because I work for people, I think when people have something to say, I'm open to listening to it. I think everyone has a different lived experience. I think majority of this country is going to have a different lived experience to what I've had because I come from a fairly privileged background.

And people are going to have things to say about that. And I think if I'm doing something that is catering to a very large percentage of India's population, then I need to be aware of what they think and what they believe in. So yeah, I think I'm open to criticism.

I think I'm somebody who takes it very critically. I take it in my stride. I take it in a sense that, okay, maybe their experience is different to what mine has been.

And I need to open myself up to criticism. I can't sit and complain about what people have to say. I actively chose to do this.

I cannot sit and complain about being trolled. I think I'm just grateful that people even acknowledge my work and see what I do on a daily basis. And for me, it's more of improving on that.

Based on what people have to say. So I take it very, very critically. In a good way.

In that sense.

[Speaker 1] (2:30:02 - 2:30:06)

The best way to deal with trolling and getting cancelled is not to care.

[Speaker 4] (2:30:06 - 2:30:06)

Yeah.

[Speaker 3] (2:30:07 - 2:30:12)

Honestly, laughing about it. Yeah. So many...

Like, I really enjoy people's company.

[Speaker 4] (2:30:12 - 2:30:20)

It changes, it's momentary. It's never going to last. I mean, it'll last for two, three days.

And then the day after, they'll find somebody else to catch. And then no one cares.

[Speaker 1] (2:30:21 - 2:30:30)

I know. I think the more you give attention to these things, the more they bother you. And the less you give attention to them, the less they bother you.

One question I missed is tractors.

[Speaker 4] (2:30:31 - 2:30:32)

Nobody doesn't get into tractors.

[Speaker 1] (2:30:33 - 2:30:34)

Navya and tractors.

[Speaker 4] (2:30:34 - 2:30:35)

Where are we to get into tractors right now?

[Speaker 1] (2:30:35 - 2:30:45)

How does a tractor work? I'll take you to the shop floor. Navya spends most of her day like test driving tractors in different towns across India.

That's how colourful her life is.

[Speaker 4] (2:30:45 - 2:30:48)

It actually took me three days to build my first tractor.

[Speaker 2] (2:30:48 - 2:30:50)

You built a tractor? It only takes three days?

[Speaker 4] (2:30:50 - 2:30:57)

No, it takes actually two minutes if you're on like an operational plant. But it took me three days, yeah. But I have built a tractor.

[Speaker 2] (2:30:57 - 2:30:59)

One second, one second. It's two minutes to build a tractor?

[Speaker 4] (2:31:00 - 2:31:01)

Yeah, in an assembly line.

[Speaker 2] (2:31:02 - 2:31:03)

In an assembly line, yeah.

[Speaker 4] (2:31:03 - 2:31:09)

Yeah, but minus that, it took me three days. But I did build a tractor. That's very cool.

[Speaker 1] (2:31:09 - 2:31:21)

Each of you is a brand. Each of you are a brand. What is your brand narrative in one line?

How will Aditya sell himself to whoever you want to sell yourself to? One sentence, I mean. One sentence.

[Speaker 2] (2:31:23 - 2:31:29)

I'd say rigour and discipline. Yeah, that's what it would be. It's boring.

[Speaker 3] (2:31:29 - 2:31:30)

No.

[Speaker 1] (2:31:31 - 2:31:36)

Okay, KD. I'm trying to be disciplined. Similar.

Quickly, whatever comes to your mind. What are you?

[Speaker 2] (2:31:36 - 2:31:47)

Two words. I don't have a personal brand. We had a town hall for our second year anniversary.

And I was cracking crazy jokes. People were loving it. KD was bombing.

No jokes, nothing.

[Speaker 5] (2:31:48 - 2:31:48)

Give some context.

[Speaker 2] (2:31:49 - 2:32:02)

We were doing like a town hall, two of us. And we were getting questions from our HR folks. Was it a coffee with currant type setup?

It was a coffee with currant kind of setup. And we were supposed to crack jokes, make it light-

hearted. Like a Zepto version.

Like a Zepto version.

[Speaker 4] (2:32:03 - 2:32:04)

Zepto cafe with... For the team.

[Speaker 2] (2:32:04 - 2:32:20)

That was our second year anniversary. This was like two months ago. A month ago.

Yeah, like one and a half, two months ago. And I was making all these jokes. People were laughing.

When KD was making jokes, nobody was laughing. But when at the end, our head of HR said, okay, who do you enjoy more? Everybody was like, oh, KD.

Everybody was like, yeah, KD.

[Speaker 1] (2:32:21 - 2:32:24)

Your relationship is so enduring. I hope it always feels this way.

[Speaker 2] (2:32:24 - 2:32:25)

I'll tell you what, we've talked about this also.

[Speaker 4] (2:32:26 - 2:32:26)

Yeah, it's very sweet.

[Speaker 2] (2:32:26 - 2:32:37)

I'll tell you one bit of my, not personal brand per se, but like a personality trait. I'm probably like people pleaser to probably like a greater extent than I should be.

[Speaker 4] (2:32:38 - 2:32:39)

Navya? What am I defining?

[Speaker 1] (2:32:40 - 2:32:42)

Your brand message. Personal brand. Navya is a brand.

[Speaker 4] (2:32:43 - 2:32:49)

I don't know. I haven't really thought about it. I mean, I don't know.

I'm just honest and vulnerable. I am who I am. If people like it, they like it.

If they don't, then...

[Speaker 2] (2:32:51 - 2:32:52)

Cliche answer, man. Give us the truth.

[Speaker 4] (2:32:52 - 2:33:13)

But it's true. I'm very honest about who I am. I'm not trying to like conform to who I'm supposed to be, which is probably a perception people have of me.

I'm not trying to conform to my family or my last name. I'm just, this is who I am. And like, you know, I'm very honest and very vulnerable about it.

So that's probably my...

[Speaker 1] (2:33:13 - 2:33:15)

Quite cool. Tara?

[Speaker 3] (2:33:16 - 2:33:31)

You know, to be honest with you, people have this, and this is the feedback that I get, right? So there's this perception of me that people have. And that much like the industry that I'm a part of is based on the outside of it.

Yeah, the outside of it.

[Speaker 5] (2:33:31 - 2:33:31)

What do you think?

[Speaker 3] (2:33:32 - 2:33:43)

Let's just say it's... And I find it to be quite dull. People tend to just decipher and make judgments and perceive you the way that you present yourself.

[Speaker 1] (2:33:44 - 2:33:44)

Right?

[Speaker 3] (2:33:45 - 2:34:22)

So that's, for lack of a better word, I'm going to use the word beauty. But to me, beauty is as

beauty does. And that's much more interesting than any other conversation when you talk about beauty.

And my industry thrives on that. So if I were a brand, or if I had a brand, or a personal brand, which I am beginning very soon, it would be based on beauty is as beauty does. Because what you do outlives you.

This is going to go. So what you perceive is also transient. So what I do, and what I do with my brand is going to last far longer and is much more meaningful.

[Speaker 2] (2:34:22 - 2:34:28)

Nikhil, you're trying to build your personal brand. What is your personal brand in one line? Confused.

[Speaker 1] (2:34:30 - 2:34:31)

Confused. Pretending not to be.

[Speaker 3] (2:34:32 - 2:34:33)

Nice. That's all of us.

[Speaker 1] (2:34:33 - 2:34:34)

You've immersed that, dude.

[Speaker 3] (2:34:34 - 2:34:38)

That should be someone's Instagram bio. That's literally all of us. That was a reverse answer.

[Speaker 1] (2:34:38 - 2:34:42)

Pretending to know what we're doing when we really have absolutely no idea what we're doing. It's actually true.

[Speaker 4] (2:34:42 - 2:34:43)

Good one.

[Speaker 1] (2:34:43 - 2:34:46)

Yeah. Pretending not to the world, but also to myself.

[Speaker 4] (2:34:47 - 2:34:50)

I agree with you. That's what we're all doing.

[Speaker 1] (2:34:51 - 2:34:58)

Okay, so thank you everyone for coming. This was so much fun. I think this has been one of the most fun podcasts.

[Speaker 4] (2:34:58 - 2:35:01)

It's been great. Thanks, guys. Signing off.

[Speaker 2] (2:35:01 - 2:35:06)

Thanks, guys. What are you saying? Nikhil, you want to ask her to sing on the spot?

[Speaker 5] (2:35:06 - 2:35:10)

Yeah, yeah. What are you saying? No, guys.

Are you going to sing for the ranger today? No, no, no. You know it.

Yeah.

[Speaker 3] (2:35:10 - 2:35:16)

What a shame. Full shame, guys. I'll send you a link later.

[Speaker 1] (2:35:16 - 2:35:20)

Mom. Maybe you can play and she can sing later. Oh, yeah.

We'll get it done.

[Speaker 4] (2:35:21 - 2:35:23)

I'll play the piano, guys. I can join.

[Speaker 2] (2:35:24 - 2:35:27)

And then they can all just watch. So cute.

[Speaker 1] (2:35:28 - 2:35:30)

We should make a band.

[Speaker 4] (2:35:30 - 2:35:33)

What is your contribution going to be, guys?

[Speaker 1] (2:35:33 - 2:35:35)

You can name it. You can name it. Backup singer.

[Speaker 4] (2:35:36 - 2:35:36)

Thank you.

[Speaker 5] (2:35:39 - 2:36:14)

Okay, guys. Nobody talks now. One, two, three, go.

Stay, only fools rush in. Oh, but I, I can't help falling in love with you. Oh, shall I stay?

[Speaker 3] (2:36:15 - 2:36:19)

Would it be a sin?

[Speaker 5] (2:36:24 - 2:36:42)

I can't help falling in love with you. Falling in love with you.